

Universal Human Values — Question Bank with Answers

HS248AT · IV Semester · Industrial Engineering & Management · RV College of Engineering
Units I, II and III — covering CIE 1, CIE 2, CIE 3 and SEE

What this covers. Every question below is drawn from the HS248AT / 21HSU48 CIE and SEE papers, the departmental Unit II and Unit III question banks, and the Unit I sample-question set. Every answer is written strictly from the prescribed text (*A Foundation Course in Human Values and Professional Ethics*, Chapters 1–10) and from the official RVCE Scheme & Solution documents for CIE 2 (2022–23) and Quiz 3/CIE 3 (2023–24). Where a scheme gives the model answer, that wording is followed.

Tags. CIE 1 CIE 2 CIE 3 SEE mark a question that has actually appeared. Scheme means the answer follows the official scheme verbatim in substance. Marks shown are as allotted in the source paper.

Two notes on scope. (1) The Unit II answer-set circulating as “unit-2 uhv question bank answers” defines justice using the legal categories *distributive / procedural / retributive / restorative*. That contradicts the official RVCE scheme, which defines the four elements of justice as *recognition of values, fulfilment, evaluation, and mutual happiness ensured*. This question bank follows the official scheme and the prescribed text throughout — write those in the exam. (2) Two SEE questions (*holistic technology; ethical human conduct in terms of values, policy and character*) belong to Chapters 11–13, which are not part of the Unit I–III material supplied. They are listed in the past-paper index but not answered here, since no source was provided for them.

UNIT I — CHAPTERS 1 TO 7

Value Education, Self-exploration, Basic Human Aspirations, and Harmony in the Self

A. Understanding Value Education (Chapter 1)

1. What do you mean by values or human values? What is value education, and why is it needed? SEE

6 M

Ans. Character-oriented education that instils basic values and ethical value in one's psyche is called **value-based education**. The subject that enables us to understand ‘*what is valuable*’ for human happiness is called **value education**.

Values form the basis for all our thoughts, behaviour and actions. Once we know what is valuable to us, these values become the basis, the anchor, for our actions. Value education is important to help everyone improve the value system he/she holds and put it to use. Once one has understood his/her values in life, one can examine and control the various choices one makes.

Value education enables us to understand our needs and visualise our goals correctly, indicates the direction for their fulfilment, helps remove our confusions and contradictions, brings harmony at all levels, and enables us to rightly utilise technological innovations. We also need to understand the universality of various human values, because only then can we have a definite and common programme for value education — and only then can we be assured of a happy and harmonious human society.

2. What is the need for value education? Explain its five aspects. SEE 6 M

Ans.

1. **Correct identification of our aspirations.** All human beings have aspirations and make plans. Before investing energy in actualising those plans, it is important to find out what we basically aspire for. Value education enables us to understand our needs, visualise our goals correctly and indicate the direction for their fulfilment.
2. **Understanding universal human values to fulfil our aspirations in continuity.** Identifying the aspiration is not enough; we must know *how* to fulfil it. Generally we pursue goals as per our appraisal and beliefs. Complete understanding of human values gives us a definite way to fulfil our aspirations.
3. **Complementarity of values and skills.** First we must know what really is conducive to human happiness — happiness for one and for all, and at all times. This is the **value domain**, the domain of wisdom. Secondly, we must learn methods and practices to actualise this goal in real life — this is the domain of **skills**. Both must go hand in hand.
4. **Evaluation of our beliefs.** In the absence of a correct understanding of universal human values we are driven by ad-hoc values and beliefs, which may or may not be true in reality. These beliefs come from what we read, see, hear, what our parents tell us, what magazines and TV say. They keep changing with time and are often mutually conflicting. Value education helps us evaluate our beliefs and assumed values.
5. **Technology and human values.** Technology is only a *means* to achieve what is considered valuable. It is not within the scope of technology to decide what is valuable — that decision lies outside it. Without this decision technology can be aimless and can be put to any use, constructive or destructive. Hence technical education must be supplemented with value education.

Value Education is a crucial missing link in the present education system. Because of this deficiency, most of our efforts may prove counterproductive, and serious crises at the individual, societal and environmental level are manifesting.

3. What are the basic guidelines for value education? SEE 6 M

Ans. To qualify as an appropriate input in value education, the content of the course must satisfy the following guidelines:

- **Universal.** It must be applicable to all human beings irrespective of caste, creed, gender, nationality or religion, and be true at all times and all places.
- **Rational.** It must appeal to human reasoning — amenable to reasoning, and not based on dogmas or blind beliefs. It cannot be a set of sermons or do's and don'ts.
- **Natural and verifiable.** It must be naturally acceptable to the human being who goes through the course, and living on the basis of such values must lead to fulfilment and happiness. It must be experientially verifiable and not based on dogmas, beliefs or assumptions.
- **All-encompassing.** Value education is aimed at transforming our consciousness and living. Hence it must cover all the dimensions (thought, behaviour, work and realisation) and all the levels (individual, family, society, nature and existence) of human life and profession.
- **Leading to harmony.** It must ultimately promote harmony within the individual, among human beings, and with the rest of nature.

4. What do you understand by the value of an entity? What is the value of a human being? 4-5 M

Ans. The value of any unit in this existence is its participation in the larger order of which it is a part. For example, the value of a pen is that it can write — here writing is the participation of the pen in the bigger order in which pen, paper and human being are all present. The value of an eye is that it can be used for seeing. The value of a vegetable plant is that it gives nutrition to animals and humans.

The **value of a human being** is the participation of the human being at different levels in this order. This participation is seen in two forms — **behaviour** and **work**. The participation pertaining to behaviour consists of the nine values in relationship: trust, respect, affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude and love. Working with material things, we have two values: utility value and artistic value. All these values are nothing but the participation of the human being in different dimensions of living.

5. Illustrate the content of value education. What should its scope be? 5 M

Ans. The scope of value education includes **all dimensions** (thought, behaviour, work and realisation) and **all levels** (individual, family, society, nature/existence) of human living.

Accordingly, the content of value education is: to understand myself, my aspirations and my happiness; to understand the goal of human life comprehensively; to understand the other entities in nature, the innate interconnectedness and the co-existence in nature/existence; and finally the role of the human being in this nature/existence entirely. Hence it has to encompass the understanding of harmony at various levels — individual, family, society, nature and existence — and finally, learning to live in accordance with this understanding by being vigilant to one's thought, behaviour and work.

6. What do you mean by values? How do they differ from skills? How are values and skills complementary? Give two examples. SEE 6 M

Ans. **Values** mean importance or participation — knowing what really is conducive to human happiness, happiness for one and for all and at all times. This is the **value domain**, the domain of wisdom; it helps us identify and set the right goals and proceed in the right direction. **Skills** mean the qualities, training and capabilities — the methods, practices and techniques to actualise that goal in real life, in various dimensions of human endeavour. This is the **domain of skills**.

To fulfil our aspirations, **both** are necessary; hence there is an essential complementarity between values and skills for the success of any human endeavour.

Example 1 (health). I want to lead a healthy life. Only *wishing* for good health will not keep my body fit; and without having understood the *meaning* of health, I will not be able to choose things correctly to keep my body fit. So I have to learn the skills to achieve the goal of good health — what food to consume, what physical workout to design. Without knowing the meaning of good health (value), health cannot be achieved; and without the skill, the goal cannot be reached.

Example 2 (technology). If we *value* the relationship with the environment, we will work to create environment-friendly technologies (the structure of technology) and also put them to right use (use of technology) — say for the enrichment of the environment and replenishment of natural resources. The engineering skill produces the technology; the value decides what to produce and how to use it. Conversely, if the relationship with the environment is something we do not value, things could be the other way round.

7. What is the need for value education in technical and other professional institutions? 5 M

Ans. The present education system has become largely **skill-based**; the prime emphasis is on science and technology. However, science and technology can only help provide the *means* to achieve what is considered valuable. It is not within their scope to provide the competence of deciding what really is valuable.

As students of technology and management, we will be studying, creating, implementing and managing technologies which affect the lives of a large number of people. Getting trained in technology without deciding what is valuable could even prove counter-productive, as technical skills are then likely to be misused.

Therefore it is essential that we understand how technology relates to us as individuals, to human society and to nature at large before we attempt to put it into practice.

Value Education is thus a crucial missing link in the present education system which must be adequately replenished. To become an excellent professional, the excellence of values along with the excellence of requisite professional skills is required.

B. Self-exploration as the Process for Value Education (Chapter 2)

8. Define self-exploration. What is the content of self-exploration? CIE 1 5 M

Ans. Self-exploration is the process of finding out what is valuable to me by investigating within myself.

Since it is I who feels happy or unhappy, successful or unsuccessful, whatever is right for me, true for me, has to be judged within myself. Through self-exploration we get the value of ourselves. We live with an entirety — family, friends, air, soil, water, trees — and we want to understand our relationship with all these; for this we need to start observing inside.

The main focus of self-exploration is **myself — the human being**. Its content is finding answers to the following two fundamental questions of all human beings:

1. **Desire / Goal:** What is my (human) desire or goal? What do I really want in life, or what is the goal of human life?
2. **Programme:** What is my (human) programme for fulfilling the desire? What is the process to fulfil this basic aspiration?

In short, these two questions cover the whole domain of human aspiration and human endeavour; thus they form the content of self-exploration.

9. Explain the process of self-exploration with a diagram. SEE 6 M

Ans. The process of self-exploration has to be kept in mind as follows:

- **Whatever is being presented is a PROPOSAL.** Don't start by assuming it to be true or false.
- **Verify it in your own right** — not on the basis of scriptures, not on the basis of readings from instruments, and not on the basis of the assertion of other human beings.
- **Firstly, verify the proposal on the basis of your natural acceptance.** Natural acceptance is a faculty present in each one of us; it is intact and invariant. We only have to start paying attention to it. (E.g. ask yourself: *Is trust naturally acceptable to me in relationship, or is mistrust?* The answer comes from within, spontaneously.)
- **Secondly, live according to the proposal to validate it experientially.** If the proposal is true, then in **behaviour** with other humans it will lead to **mutual fulfilment / mutual happiness**, and in **work** with the rest of nature it will lead to **mutual prosperity**.

Diagram — Process of Self-exploration

Proposal (input)	Verify	Live accordingly
It is a proposal • Don't assume it to be true • Verify it in your own right – Not on the basis of scriptures – Not on the basis of readings from instruments – Not on the basis of others • Self-verification	On the basis of Natural Acceptance <i>Keep asking again and again: “What is my natural acceptance?”</i>	Experiential Validation • Behaviour with human → mutual happiness • Work with rest of nature → mutual prosperity
↓ Results in REALIZATION and UNDERSTANDING ↓ Tested for → Assurance Satisfaction Universality (same for all Time, Space and Individual)		

The answers we get on having realisation and understanding are: **(a) Assuring** — “I am assured of the answer in myself”; **(b) Satisfying** — “I am satisfied that the answers are fulfilling for me”; **(c) Universal** — the answers are the same for everyone, invariant with respect to time, space and individual. If the answer fails any of these criteria, it is most likely coming from past beliefs or conditioning and not from natural acceptance, and needs to be re-verified.

10. What do you mean by natural acceptance and experiential validation? Explain them as the two mechanisms of self-exploration. SEE 5 M

Ans. **Natural acceptance** implies unconditional and total acceptance of the self, people and environment; it also refers to the absence of any exception from others. It is a faculty present in each one of us, intact and invariant, and we can always refer to it to know what is right for us. Once we fully and truly commit ourselves on the basis of natural acceptance, we feel a holistic sense of inner harmony, tranquillity and fulfilment.

Experiential validation is the process that infuses direct experience with the learning environment and content. It may be regarded as a philosophy and methodology in which the direct experience and focused reflection of the individual helps to increase knowledge, develop skill and clarify values. We live according to the proposal, and if it is true, our behaviour with humans leads to mutual happiness and our work with the rest of nature leads to mutual prosperity. When what we already believe to be true of us is validated by situations, phenomena or outcomes, we may term it experiential validation.

Self-exploration takes place in **the Self, and not in the body**.

11. Illustrate the purpose of self-exploration. (Seven points) 5 M

Ans.

1. **It is a process of dialogue between “what you are” and “what you really want to be”.** If these two are the same, there is no problem. If on investigation we find they are not the same, we are living with this contradiction, and we need to resolve this conflict within us.
2. **It is a process of self-evolution through self-investigation.** It successively enables us to bridge the gap between ‘what we are’ and ‘what we want to be’; we become qualitatively better.
3. **It is a process of knowing oneself and, through that, knowing the entire existence.** The exploration starts by asking simple questions about ourselves, which gives clarity about our being, and then clarity about everything around us.
4. **It is a process of recognising one's relationship with every unit in existence and fulfilling it.** We become aware of our right relationship with other entities, discover the interconnectedness and co-existence, and live accordingly.
5. **It is a process of knowing human conduct, human character and living accordingly.** We all desire certainty and stability; once we know our own true nature, we understand our participation with the other things we live with — this is the ethical or humane conduct.
6. **It is a process of being in harmony in oneself and in harmony with the entire existence.**
7. **It is a process of identifying our innateness and moving towards self-organisation and self-expression.**

Svatva → Swatantrata → Swarajya

12. What do you understand by the terms *svatva*, *swatantrata* and *swarajya*? How are they related?

5 M

Ans.

- **Svatva (innateness):** the innateness of the self — the natural acceptance of harmony.
- **Swatantrata (self-organisation):** being self-organised — being in harmony with oneself.
- **Swarajya (self-expression):** self-expression, self-extension — living in harmony with others, and thus participation towards harmony in the whole existence.

Svatva → Swatantrata → Swarajya

The *svatva* is already there, intact in each one of us. By being in dialogue with it, we attain *swatantrata*, which enables us to work for *swarajya*. If we live in contradiction, it means we are not self-organised and are living with pre-conditionings, having assumed certain things and accumulated desires without first evaluating them — then we are **partantra** (enslaved). On the other hand, when we identify our innateness, what we really want to be, and establish a dialogue with it, it enables us to start living with this harmony; it starts expressing itself through our harmonious behaviour and work, and naturally extends to our participation with the surroundings. This is working towards *swarajya*.

13. “Natural acceptance is innate, invariant and universal.” Explain this statement with an example.

5 M

Ans. We can verify proposals on the basis of the following characteristics of natural acceptance:

1. **Natural acceptance does not change with time.** It remains invariant with time. For example, our natural acceptance for trust and respect does not change with age; people a hundred years ago also had the same natural acceptance.
2. **It does not depend on the place.** Whether we are in New Delhi, New York or Abu Dhabi, if we address our natural acceptance the answer would still be the same.
3. **It does not depend on our beliefs or past conditionings.** No matter how deep our belief or past conditioning, as long as we ask ourselves the question sincerely and refer deep within ourselves, the answer will always be the same.
4. **This natural acceptance is ‘constantly there’, something we can refer to.** Try it: think of cheating or exploiting someone. The moment you think of this, you sense a contradiction within and feel unhappy that very instant. Every time we do something not acceptable to us, there is a contradiction in us, because the thought or deed conflicts with our own natural acceptance.
5. **Natural acceptance is the same for all of us.** It is part and parcel of every human being; it is part of human-ness. No human being finds disrespect acceptable in relationship. Our assumptions and choices, likes and dislikes may be different, but on basic and common issues like the need to be happy, to be respected, to be prosperous, we are all the same.

Example: Take the proposal — ‘respect is a value in human relation’. When I verify at the level of natural acceptance, I find that it is naturally acceptable to me. Similarly, when I behave with respect, it is mutually fulfilling to me and to the other. Thus the proposal is **true**. If it fails either of the two tests, it is untrue.

C. The Basic Human Aspirations (Chapter 3)

14. What is happiness? “To be in a state of harmony is happiness” — explain and illustrate with two examples from your day-to-day life.

SEE

6 M

Ans. Happiness may be defined as **being in harmony/synergy in the state or situation that I live in.**

“The state/situation in which I live, if there is harmony/synergy in it, then I like to be in that state/situation.” i.e. “To be in a state of liking is happiness.”

Conversely: “The state/situation in which I live, if there is conflict/contradiction in it, then I do not like to be in that state or situation” — **to be in a state of disliking is unhappiness. Thus, to be in a state of harmony is happiness; to be in a state of disharmony or contradiction is unhappiness.**

When we are in such a state of happiness we experience no struggle, no contradiction or conflict within, and we wish to have its continuity. One important characteristic of this feeling is that we *like to continue* it.

Example 1 — Respect. Respect is a state of harmony between two human beings. When I respect the other and the other respects me, I like to be in that situation; it gives me happiness.

Example 2 — Harmony in my own thoughts. When there is harmony in my thoughts and feelings, I feel relaxed and want to be in that situation. This feeling is happiness. If this harmony is disturbed — say I am confused or in conflict about a decision — I feel uneasy, i.e. unhappy.

It should be noted that we do get an *impression* of happiness through sensory interaction (tasty food, a beautiful picture, a sweet fragrance). However, these impressions are always short-lived and their continuity can never be ensured.

15. What is the meaning of prosperity? How can you say that you are prosperous? 5 M

Ans. Prosperity is the feeling of having or making available more than the required physical facilities.

Physical facilities are the material things we use to fulfil the needs of the body; when we are able to cater to the needs of the body adequately, we feel prosperous.

To ascertain prosperity, **two things** are essential:

1. **Correct assessment of the need for physical facilities** — identification of the required quantity. We can be prosperous only if there is a limit to the need for physical facilities. If there is no limit, then whatsoever be the availability with us, the feeling of prosperity cannot be assured.
2. **The competence of making available more than the required physical facilities** (through production). Just assessing the need is not enough; we need to be able to produce or make available more than the perceived need.

Since for all our physical facilities we are directly or indirectly dependent on nature, the continuity of prosperity can be ensured only if our production systems are in harmony with nature.

16. How do prosperity and wealth differ? What is more acceptable to us and why? CIE 1 SEE 8 M

Ans.

Wealth	Prosperity
Wealth is a physical thing . It means having money, or having a lot of physical facilities, or both.	Prosperity is a feeling of having more than required physical facilities. It is not just physical facilities.
It can be quantified and accumulated without limit; there is no point at which it is “enough”.	It requires (a) correct assessment of the need, and (b) the competence to make available more than that need.
Having wealth does not by itself lead to sharing; a person may have a lot of money but not want to share even a bit of it.	The feeling of prosperity naturally leads to sharing with the other, becoming an aid by enriching the other. Deprivation leads to exploiting the other — this is a simple test of prosperity.
Wealth is only a part of prosperity — a means to the end.	Prosperity is the end ; the basic desire is to <i>feel</i> prosperous, to have a feeling of having enough.

Illustration. A person has a lot of wealth, but gets worried when a guest may stay longer than expected and might have to be fed. The person *has wealth*, but *feels deprived*. On the other hand, someone who does not have a lot of wealth may welcome you into his/her house and ask you to stay back for a few days and help out — this is an indication of feeling prosperous. If one felt prosperous, one would have shared what one has, since there is far more than enough anyway.

What is more acceptable and why. On checking our natural acceptance, we find that **prosperity is more acceptable**. Given the choice between *accumulating more and more wealth while feeling deprived* and *having requisite wealth and feeling prosperous*, we find the latter naturally acceptable. Not only do we want wealth, we want to *feel* prosperous too. Wealth is only a means to that end. In order to feel prosperous, we need to first decide how much wealth is needed, else it is like trying to fill water in a glass that has no bottom — the glass will never be filled, howsoever one may try. This is why today we are busy accumulating wealth but do not feel prosperous: we do not identify our need, and hence no matter how much we have, it is always less, and we feel deprived.

17. Critically examine the prevailing notions of happiness and prosperity and their consequences. / There are many problems manifest today at the level of individual, family, society and nature. Identify some of these. CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. In the current scenario, we are generally trying to achieve happiness and prosperity by **maximising accumulation and consumption of physical facilities**. This is an attempt to achieve happiness through pleasant sensory interactions. Physical facilities are not seen in terms of fulfilling bodily needs but as a means of maximising happiness. This has resulted in a wrong assessment of wants for physical facilities as being **unlimited**.

But this pursuit is **self-defeating**. Neither can we hope to achieve continuous happiness through sensory interactions, nor can we have prosperity, as it amounts to trying to fulfil unlimited wants through limited resources. This effort is engendering problems at all levels; it is becoming anti-ecological and anti-people, and is threatening human survival itself. Some consequences:

- **At the level of the individual** — rising problems of depression, psychological disorders, suicides, stress, insecurity, psycho-somatic diseases, loneliness, lack of confidence and conviction.
- **At the level of the family** — breaking of joint families, mistrust, conflict between older and younger generations, insecurity in relationships, divorce, dowry tortures, family feuds, wasteful expenditure in family functions, neglect of older people.
- **At the level of society** — growing incidences of terrorism and naxalism, rising communalism, spreading casteism, racial and ethnic struggle, wars between nations, attempts at genocide, fear of nuclear and genetic warfare, corruption, adulteration, proliferation of lethal weapons.
- **At the level of nature** — global warming; water, air, soil and noise pollution; resource depletion of minerals and mineral oils; sizeable deforestation; loss of fertility of soil.

All these problems are a direct outcome of an **incorrect understanding** — our wrong notion about happiness and prosperity and their continuity. It therefore calls for an urgent need for human beings to correctly understand happiness and prosperity as well as the sustainable way to achieve these.

18. What do the abbreviations SVDD, SSDD and SSSS signify? 4 M

Ans. To achieve our basic aspirations we need to work for right understanding as the base, on which we can work for relationship and then physical facilities. Today we are not working according to this, and hence we find two kinds of people in the world:

1. **SVDD — Sadhan Viheen Dukhi Daridra:** Materially deficient, unhappy and deprived. Those who do not have physical facilities/wealth and feel unhappy and deprived.
2. **SSDD — Sadhan Sampann Dukhi Daridra:** Materially affluent, unhappy and deprived. Those who have physical facilities/wealth but still feel unhappy and deprived.

These are states we do not want to be in. We want to move to the third category:

3. **SSSS — Sadhan Sampann Sukhi Samriddha:** Materially adequate, happy and prosperous.

Presently, as we look around, we find most people in the first two categories, while the natural acceptance of all human beings is to be in the category of **SSSS**.

D. The Programme to Fulfil Basic Human Aspirations (Chapter 4)

19. What are the requirements to fulfil basic human aspirations? Explain each and give the correct priority among them. CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. Our basic aspirations are **happiness (mutual fulfilment)** and **prosperity (mutual prosperity)**.

Happiness is ensured by relationships with other human beings, and prosperity is ensured by working on physical facilities. Three things are needed:

1. **Right Understanding.** This refers to the higher-order human skills — the need to learn and utilise our intelligence most effectively. It is needed in myself; it is a need of 'I'.
2. **Relationship.** This refers to the interpersonal relationships a person builds in his/her life — at home, at the workplace and in society. We want to have the right feelings in relationship; this too is a need of 'I'.
3. **Physical Facilities.** This includes the physiological needs of individuals and indicates the necessities as well as the comforts of life. It means the feeling of having or being able to have more physical facilities than is needed. This is a need of the **Body**.

Correct priority: Right Understanding → Relationship → Physical Facilities.

Right understanding comes first, because in order to resolve the issues in human relationships we need to understand them first, and this comes from 'right understanding of relationship'. Similarly, in order to be prosperous and to enrich nature, we need the right understanding — it enables us to work out our requirements for physical facilities and hence correctly distinguish between wealth and prosperity. With nature as well, we need to understand the harmony in nature and how we can complement it.

20. “Right understanding + Relationship = Mutual fulfilment; Right understanding + Physical facilities = Mutual prosperity.” Illustrate the above with two examples for each. CIE 1 8 M

Ans. Our basic aspirations are happiness (mutual fulfilment) and prosperity (mutual prosperity). Happiness is ensured by relationships with other human beings; prosperity is ensured by working on physical facilities. The reason we are unable to have either today is that we have not focused on one more aspect — **right understanding**.

Right understanding + Relationship = Mutual fulfilment	Right understanding + Physical facilities = Mutual prosperity
With right understanding, we can be happy in ourselves and work to have fulfilling relationships with humans — both sides feel fulfilled and satisfied from the interaction.	With right understanding we correctly identify our need for physical facilities, produce more than required, and interact with nature in a way that is mutually enriching.

Examples for Mutual fulfilment:

1. **Trust in the family.** With right understanding, I see that at the level of intention every human being wants my happiness, and only competence may be lacking. So when a family member fails to do something for me, I do not doubt his/her intention; I become a help. The relationship is fulfilling to both — mutual fulfilment. Without right understanding, I doubt the intention, we fight, and both of us are unhappy.
2. **Respect for a classmate.** With right understanding, I evaluate the other rightly — at the level of ‘I’ the other is similar to me in aspiration, programme and potential. I neither over-evaluate nor under-evaluate. The other feels rightly evaluated and I feel at ease; both are fulfilled. Without it, I differentiate on body, wealth or beliefs, and both feel uneasy.

Examples for Mutual prosperity:

1. **Farming.** With right understanding, I use a farming method that retains/enhances the fertility of the soil. I keep getting grain to feed my body and the soil is enriched — both the human and nature gain. Without it, heavy chemical use makes the land unfit for agriculture; I lose and so does nature.
2. **Wood and trees.** The wood one person requires in a lifetime can be obtained from about four full-grown trees; a person can plant far more than four in a lifetime — ten, twenty or a hundred. With right understanding I identify my limited need and plant more than I take, so I feel prosperous and nature is enriched. Without it, I over-produce and deforest, feeling deprived all the same.

Right Understanding → Relationship → *Happiness with human beings* | Right Understanding → Physical Facilities → *Mutual prosperity with the rest of nature*

21. “Physical facilities are necessary and complete for animals, while they are necessary but not complete for humans.” Comment. 5 M

Ans.

For Animals — necessary and complete	For Humans — necessary but not complete
Animals need physical things to survive, mainly to take care of their body. A cow will look for food when it is hungry; once it gets the grass or fodder, it eats, and then sits around to chew at leisure. As long as animals have physical things they are largely fine. They don't desire other things like knowledge, or a peaceful animal society, or getting a good MBA.	While physical facilities are necessary for human beings, they are not complete by themselves to fulfil our needs. Once you have had your fill, you do not just sit around and relax. We all have other needs and other plans — going to a movie, reading a book, going to college, spending time with family and friends — the list is endless.

The reason is that a human being is the **co-existence of the Self ('I') and the Body**. Physical facilities are needed for the **Body**; having them ensures the fulfilment of the need of the Body. It does not address the need of **'I'** — happiness, trust, respect. Hence, besides physical facilities, we also want **relationship** (mutual fulfilment) and **right understanding**. Our needs are more than just physical facilities; we need physical facilities, but the need does not end there.

22. What do you mean by animal consciousness and human consciousness? Explain with the help of a diagram. How does the transformation take place? 5 M

Ans.

- **Animal Consciousness:** giving all priority to physical facilities only, or to live solely on the basis of physical facilities.
- **Human Consciousness:** living with all three — Right understanding, Relationship and Physical facilities.

Diagram

Right Understanding → { Relationship with human → **Mutual Happiness** } + { Physical facilities → **Mutual Prosperity** }

Physical facilities: for humans — *necessary but not complete*; for animals — *necessary and complete*.

To live solely on the basis of physical facilities = **Animal Consciousness** ↓ *Transformation* ↓ To live with all three = **Human Consciousness** — *this is where we want to be*.

From the diagram we can say: for animals, physical facilities are necessary as well as complete, whereas for human beings they are necessary but not complete. Working only for physical facilities is living with Animal Consciousness. Working for right understanding as the first priority, followed by relationship and physical facilities, implies living with Human Consciousness.

The transformation from Animal Consciousness to Human Consciousness can be accomplished only by working for **right understanding as the first priority**. This transformation forms the basis for human values and value-based living. The content of education is the understanding of harmony at all four levels of our existence — from myself to the entire existence; and **sanskara** (right living) refers to the ability to live in harmony at all four levels. This dimension of society works to ensure 'right understanding' and 'right feelings' in every individual, i.e. the all-encompassing solution called **samadhan**, and ensures that our succeeding generations have both the content and the environment available to work towards achieving their goal of continuous happiness and prosperity.

E. Human Being as Co-existence of Self ('I') and Body (Chapter 5)

23. Distinguish between the needs of the Self and the needs of the Body. SEE 5 M

Ans. A human being is the **co-existence of the Self ('I') and the Body**, with an exchange of information between the two. Their needs are fundamentally different:

	Self ('I')	Body
Needs are	Trust, respect, happiness... i.e. Happiness (sukha)	Food, clothing, shelter, instruments... i.e. Physical Facilities (suvidha)
In time	Continuous — I want to be happy and respected all the time, not even for a moment otherwise.	Temporary — food, clothes, shelter are needed only periodically. Even breathing is not continuous; we inhale, then exhale.
In quantity	Qualitative (no quantity) — we cannot speak of one kg of respect or two litres of affection. Either the feeling is there or it is not.	Quantitative (limited in quantity) — four chapattis, one bicycle. Beyond the limit, consumption becomes <i>necessary and tasteful</i> → <i>unnecessary but tasty</i> → <i>unnecessary and tasteless</i> → <i>intolerable</i> .
Fulfilled by	Right understanding and right feelings	Physico-chemical things — food, clothing, etc.
Activities	Desiring, thinking, etc. — knowing, assuming, recognising, fulfilling	Breathing, heartbeat, etc. — recognising, fulfilling
Type	Conscious (non-material)	Physico-chemical (material)

The confusion today. A common mistake is that we mix these two sets of needs and assume that “all we need is physical facilities (suvidha), and that will automatically ensure happiness (sukha)”. The reality is that we need both, since one is the need of the Body and the other the need of 'I'. **One cannot replace the other**, and the programmes for the two are also different. For example, sitting in an air-conditioned room on a comfortable sofa with a person for whom you have a feeling of opposition — the body is well taken care of, but you are unhappy. Our gross misunderstandings today are: *Body = 'I'; Facilities = Happiness; Clothes = Respect*.

F. Harmony in the Self — and with the Body (Chapters 6 & 7)

24. How can we ensure harmony in the Self ('I')? CIE 1 4 M

Ans. The activities of **imaging (desire)**, **analysing (thought)** and **selecting/tasting (expectation)** are constantly taking place in 'I'; together they are called **imagination**. Today these are largely set either by **pre-conditioning (manyata)** or by **sensations from the body** — i.e. from the outside — and are not self-verified on the basis of our natural acceptance. In this state we are **partantra** (enslaved), and our desires, thoughts and expectations are in conflict among themselves and with our own natural acceptance. This is the cause of unhappiness.

The way to ensure harmony in the Self is a **four-step process**:

1. Becoming aware that the human being is the **co-existence of 'I' and the Body**.
2. Becoming aware that the **Body is only an instrument of 'I'**; 'I' is the seer, doer and enjoyer.
3. Becoming aware of the activities of **desire, thought and expectation**, and passing each of these through your **natural acceptance**.
4. Understanding the **harmony at all levels of our existence** by verifying the proposals at the level of natural acceptance. This leads to **realization and understanding**, which in turn become the basis for desire, thought and expectation — and this leads to harmony in 'I' in continuity.

The outcome: desires, thoughts and expectations become definite and have a clear flow, so there is no contradiction; we have clarity about ourselves, our basic aspiration and the way to fulfil it; we understand all the levels of our living and live accordingly; and we live in a state of **svatantrata** — self-organised in our imagination, behaviour and work. This results in continuous happiness and prosperity.

Realization & Understanding (1, 2) → Desire (3) → Thought (4) → Expectation (5) = svatantra (self-organised)

25. Define *Sanyama* and *Svasthya*. How are the two related? 4–5 M

Ans. The harmony of 'I' with the Body is in the form of **Sanyama** on the part of 'I' and **Svasthya** on the part of the Body.

- **Sanyama (Self-regulation):** the feeling of responsibility in the Self ('I') for **nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising** the Body.
- **Svasthya (Health):** the state of the Body when it is **fit to act according to the needs of the Self ('I')**, and there is **harmony among the different parts of the Body**.

Relation: Sanyama is the basis of Svasthya. When I live with Sanyama, there is harmony among the different parts of the Body and the Body is fit to be used as an instrument of 'I'. If there is Sanyama, health can be ensured; if Sanyama is not there, even good health can be lost. Today, in place of being responsible to the Body, we rely more on medication; we go for newer sources of sensual pleasure and irresponsible practices in living, and thus produce new diseases day by day. An increase in hospitals or medical grants is no substitute for Sanyama.

26. “Realization and understanding are essential for happiness and harmony.” Explain. SEE 5 M

Ans. Happiness is being in a state of harmony; unhappiness is a state of conflict and contradiction. We have seen that this conflict is primarily **inside us** — between our imagination (desire, thought, expectation) and our natural acceptance.

As long as our desires are being set from the outside — by a sensation from the body or by a pre-conditioning (manyata) — there is every chance that we are in conflict, and we are **partantra** (enslaved). Not only are the desires, thoughts and expectations in conflict among themselves, they are also in conflict with our own natural acceptance, and this creates unhappiness.

Through the process of **self-exploration**, the activities of **realization** and **understanding** get activated. Once we start operating at the level of realization and understanding, our desires, thoughts and expectations get aligned with our own natural acceptance, and we become **svatantra** (self-organised). There is self-organisation in my activities, leading to continuity of happiness — this is **harmony in the Self ('I')**.

Further, since the understanding is **invariant**, the desires arising from it are also **definite**, and hence the thoughts, selections, behaviour and work are also in harmony. This is what gives **definiteness of human conduct**. Realization and understanding are therefore not optional extras — they are the very basis of continuous happiness, which is the basic human aspiration.

Harmony in the Family and in the Society — From Family Order to World Family Order

A. Relationship, Justice and the State Today (Chapter 8)

27. “Family is a natural laboratory to understand human relationships” — elaborate. / Relationship IS, and it exists between one *jeevan* and the other *jeevan*. Examine. CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. The family is the **basic unit of human interaction**. Each one of us is naturally a part of a family that includes father, mother, brothers and sisters, and then grandparents, aunts, uncles, cousins. These relationships are a reality of our life — we are **born into** them; we have not *created* them.

Here is the set of proposals the text asks us to verify:

1. **Relationship IS, and it exists between the Self ('I') and the other Self ('I').** It is not possible to create the relationships that are existent in a family; we are naturally born into them. It is the person's self which is primarily related to the other person's self. The Body is only a means to express or receive our relationship — the Body is incapable of understanding as well as having feelings. For example, a mother feels related to the child she has given birth to; the body of the child has its source in the body of the mother, but neither body has feelings — it is the Self of the mother and the child who feel connected.
2. **The Self ('I') has feelings in a relationship, and these feelings are between 'I' and 'I'.** Who wants trust in relationship — you or the Body? The answer is, *I* want trust; and from the other 'I'. There is no part of the body that wants trust or respect.
3. **These feelings in the Self are definite — they can be identified with definiteness.** They are the values characterising relationships: trust, respect, affection, and so on.
4. **Recognising and fulfilling these feelings leads to mutual happiness in relationship.**

Why the family is a laboratory. By living in relationships at all times in the family, we get the occasion to gain the assurance that the other person is **an aid to me and not a hindrance**. In the family we learn to recognise relationship, recognise the definite feelings or values, and learn how to fulfil them. The evaluation that takes place mutually in these close relationships, leading to mutual happiness, instils a confidence in us that we can live the right way with human beings. The family is thus a laboratory of sorts in which we *live* our understanding. On getting assured, it becomes easy to see that **society is an extension of family**, and that it is possible to live in harmony with every human being — thus laying the foundation for an undivided human race, from **family order to world family order**.

28. What is 'justice'? What are its four elements? Is it a continuous or a temporary need?

SEE

CIE 2 QB

Scheme

5 M

Ans. Justice is the recognition of values (the definite feelings) in relationship, their fulfilment, and the right evaluation of the fulfilment resulting in mutual happiness (Ubhay-tripti). Justice concerns itself with the proper ordering of things and people within a society.

The four elements of justice:

1. **Recognition of values** — recognising the definite feelings in the relationship
2. **Fulfilment** of those values
3. **Evaluation** of the fulfilment
4. **Mutual happiness** ensured

When all four are ensured, justice is ensured. **Mutual fulfilment is the hallmark of justice.**

Self ('I') —relationship— Self ('I') → Recognise the VALUES → Fulfilment of VALUES → Evaluate the fulfilment → Mutual happiness

Is it continuous or temporary? Justice is a **continuous need**. Justice is essential in *all* relationships — be it with the small kid in your house, your old grandpa, the maid in the house, your fast friends or your distant relations. We want justice not on a few occasions but **every moment**, and in *every* relationship, not just a few. We need to grow up in relationships to ensure the continuity of justice in all our relationships. It is also worth asking whether justice will get ensured in the family or in courts of law — in justice there is *mutual fulfilment* for both parties, which a judgement and punishment cannot deliver.

29. What is the meaning of justice in human relationships? How does it follow from family to world family?

CIE 2

SEE

Scheme

5 M

Ans. Justice is the recognition of values (the definite feelings in a relationship), their fulfilment, and the right evaluation of the fulfilment resulting in mutual happiness. There are four elements: recognition of values, fulfilment, evaluation, and mutual happiness ensured. When all four are ensured, justice is ensured; mutual fulfilment is the hallmark of justice.

From family to world family. Justice **starts from the family and slowly expands to the world family**. The child gets an understanding of justice in the family. With this understanding, he/she goes out into society and interacts with people. All of us are children at some point of time and grow into adults. In the family we learn to recognise relationship, recognise the definite feelings or values, and learn how to fulfil them. The evaluation that takes place mutually in close relationships, leading to mutual happiness, instils a confidence in us that we can live the right way with human beings; unless this confidence is ensured, we remain shaky in relationships.

If the understanding of justice is ensured in the family, there will be justice in all the interactions we have in the world at large. If we do *not* understand the values in relationships, we are governed by our petty prejudices and conditionings. We may treat people as high or low based on their body (particular caste, or sex or race or tribe), on the basis of the wealth one possesses, or the belief systems that one follows. All this is a source of injustice and leads to a **fragmented society**, while our natural acceptance is for an **undivided society and universal human order**.

Having explored the harmony in human beings, we are able to explore the harmony in the family. This enables us to understand the harmony at the level of society and nature/existence. And this is the way the harmony in our living grows — we slowly get the competence to live in harmony with all human beings.

30. What is the outcome when we try to identify relationships based on the exchange of physical facilities? 5 M

Ans. We are unable to see ourselves as the co-existence of the Self ('I') and the Body. As a result we see ourselves as a body and the other as a body, and we subsequently **reduce our relationships and the feelings in the relationship to the level of the body**. We tend to assume that we have relationship with our blood-related family members only.

As a result of this mistaken assumption, we have **reduced our expectations in relationships to the mere fulfilment of physical facilities**. We evaluate all our relationships in terms of material things like money, property, etc. In short, the purpose of relationship has been reduced to physical and material needs and their exchange. Hence we feel that working for physical facilities alone is enough, or we assume that as long as we accumulate physical facilities and provide the same to the other, the relationship is automatically fulfilled.

The outcome. Suppose your father earns enough money and ensures that your physical needs are taken care of, but does not spend time with you, does not care for you, or instead behaves badly with you — would you feel satisfied? The answer is **NO**. Nowadays we also hear of youngsters earning a lot of money who, instead of taking care of their parents and fulfilling their needs of feelings at the level of 'I' (trust, respect, affection), just put their parents in some old-age home. The parents have plenty to eat, good clothes, a big TV, servants — but this is not fulfilling for them, since the needs of the 'I', the feelings in 'I', have been totally ignored.

The fact is: what we need first is the **right understanding**, and this is not ensured by having money. Secondly, we need the **feelings in relationships** to be fulfilled, which is also not ensured by having money.

B. The Values in Human Relationships (Chapter 8)

31. Enumerate the important values which lie at the base of good relationships. / List the foundation value and the complete value in human relationship, and explain each with one example. CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. Being in relationship, we have feelings for the other. These feelings cannot be replaced by any material or physical things. They are **definite** and they are the **values** in a relationship. There are **nine** such values:

#	Value	Meaning (as defined in the text)
1	Trust (Vishvas)	To be assured that each human being inherently wants oneself and the other to be happy and prosperous. The foundation value (adhara mulya).
2	Respect (Sammana)	Right evaluation — to be evaluated as I am, without over-, under- or otherwise evaluation.
3	Affection (Sneha)	The feeling of being related to the other; the acceptance of the other as one's relative.
4	Care (Mamata)	The feeling to nurture and protect the <i>body</i> of our relative.
5	Guidance (Vatsalya)	The feeling of ensuring right understanding and right feelings in the other (my relative).
6	Reverence (Shraddha)	The feeling of acceptance of excellence in the other.
7	Glory (Gaurava)	The feeling for someone who has made efforts for excellence.
8	Gratitude (Kritagyata)	The feeling of acceptance for those who have made effort for <i>my</i> excellence.
9	Love (Prema)	The feeling of being related to <i>all</i> . The complete value (purna mulya).

Foundation value — Trust, with example: In a family, when a member fails to do something for me, if I am assured that at the level of *intention* he/she means well for me and only the *competence* was lacking, I do not get hurt; I become a help to him/her. A relationship without trust results in opposition; the relationship itself gets shaken up. Lack of trust is what ultimately leads to extreme situations like war.

Complete value — Love, with example: It starts with identifying that I am related to *one* other human being (the feeling of affection) and slowly expands to the feeling of being related to *all* human beings. When I am able to feel related even to a stranger on the road — recognising that at the level of 'I' he/she is exactly like me — that is love. This feeling of love lays down the basis of an **Undivided Society**.

Two useful points the text stresses: the **basic** values to be understood are **trust and respect** — if we have these, the remaining values flow quite naturally. And **only Care (mamata) requires physical facilities**; for all the other feelings, what we essentially need is their proper understanding.

32. What do you understand by trust? Differentiate between intention and competence with examples.

Why is this distinction important?

CIE 2

SEE

CIE 2 QB

5 M

Ans. Trust (vishvas) is defined as: **“To be assured that each human being inherently wants oneself and the other to be happy and prosperous.”** We feel assured of the other person when we are sure that the other wants to work for my happiness and prosperity. Whenever I feel the other will deny my happiness and/or prosperity, I am afraid of that person. Trust is the **foundation value** (adhara mulya) of relationship.

To understand it, examine four proposals: (1) I want to make myself happy; (2) I want to make the other happy; (3) The other wants to be happy; (4) The other wants to make me happy. Answering the fourth with deep exploration is the basis of gaining trust in the other. On examining, we find there are **two parts** in this exploration:

Intention (natural acceptance) — <i>wanting to</i>	Competence (ability to fulfil) — <i>being able to do</i>
1a) I want to be happy ✓ 2a) I want to make the other happy ✓ 3a) The other wants to be happy ✓ 4a) The other wants to make me happy ✓ (<i>after exploration</i>)	1b) I am always happy ? 2b) I always make the other happy ? 3b) The other is always happy ? 4b) The other always makes me happy ?
What we really want to be	What we are

The mistake we make. When we judge *ourselves*, we judge on the basis of our **intention**; when we judge *the other*, we judge on the basis of his/her **competence**. We say “I wanted to do well, but I could not” — but for the other we say “He did not want to do well”. “Wanting to” is the intention; “could not” is the lack of competence.

Example. You are walking on your college campus and your close friend walks by from the other direction. You look at him and smile, but he barely notices you and keeps walking with his head down. You feel angry and disappointed, and assume he wants to ignore you. Later you find out that he was disturbed since he had lost his wallet. You immediately feel alright and are not angry any more. What happened? You **doubted your friend's intention**. It was not that he *intended* to ignore you; only that he was preoccupied. Once you knew this, you realised it was not his intention but only **his competence that was lacking at that moment**.

Why the distinction is important. Intention is **always correct** and is the same in all of us; it is only the competence that is lacking, which can be improved by right understanding. When we are assured of the intention of the other and find that the competence is lacking, we **become a help** to the other. When we doubt the intention of the other, we **get into opposition**. You cannot have a problem in relationship unless you have ended up doubting the intention of the other person, no matter how close you are to them.

33. In our behaviour, we generally observe our intention and others' lack of competence. Does it lead to mutual happiness? What is the alternative? Explain with an example. CIE 2 QB Scheme 5 M

Ans. No, it does not lead to mutual happiness. We trust our own intention while we are not ready to trust the other's intention. It is the same for the others as well — while the other trusts his/her own intentions, he/she does not trust mine. Hence **mistrust is born and we deny the relationship.**

When we are judging ourselves we are judging on the basis of our **intention**, whereas when we are judging the other we are judging him on the basis of his **competence**. We are sure that we want to make the other happy, but we are not sure that the other wants to make us happy. We find that while we look at our intention we are sure of it; we are not sure of the other's intention. We are actually seeing their competence and making a conclusion on their intention — we say “I wanted to do well, but I could not”, but for the other we say “He did not want to do well”. “Wanting to” is the intention; “could not” is the lack of competence.

The alternative. We can see that we are not able to fulfil our intentions in terms of our competence at all times; it is the same for the other as well. We want to be related to the other, and we want the other to be related to us, irrespective of who this other is. If we have **trust** in the other, we are able to see the other as a **relative and not as an adversary**. We then become ready to become **a help to the other**. Intentions are always correct; it is only the competence that is lacking, which can be improved by the right understanding.

Example. Suppose a friend promises to bring your notes to class and forgets. If I doubt his intention (“he did not want to help me”), I get irritated, we argue, and both of us are unhappy — there is no mutual happiness. If instead I am assured of his intention and see that only his competence (memory, planning) was lacking, I do not get hurt; I remind him and help him organise better next time. He is comfortable and so am I — this is mutual happiness, and his competence also improves.

34. There is a common saying: “If you trust everybody, people will take undue advantage of you.” What is the basic error in this statement? / How can I trust a stranger? CIE 2 QB Scheme 5 M

Ans. The basic error is that if we trust everybody, people will *not* take undue advantage of us. On the contrary, it gives us **inner strength** and we become far more effective in interacting with and dealing with different people. This is simply because we already are sitting with the knowledge of what the person truly wants, truly intends, even though the person may not know this himself/herself.

Hence our ability to interact with people becomes far more effective, and in the process **we don't get hurt, we don't get disturbed, and we end up becoming an aid to the other**. In other words, becoming aware, having the right understanding, and living with the assurance in the relationship does not mean becoming “stupid” — it only makes us **more competent**. People can take advantage of you only if you *do not* have the right understanding, which is the state we are in today.

Further, what is being said is that we have **trust in the intention of everyone**; but when it comes to **making a programme** with someone, I evaluate my competence, I evaluate his competence, and make the programme accordingly. This makes me more effective than if I did it otherwise, i.e. by doubting his intention.

“How can I trust a stranger?” If you are able to see the relationship with the person at the level of ‘I’, you will see that the other person is also like you. He/she too has natural acceptance for the same things as you, wants to make himself/herself happy, and wants to make you happy at the level of intention — just as you do. But he/she may be unaware of this fact, just as you were, and hence may be interacting with you on the basis of your *competence*. **If we interact with or evaluate the other person at the level of competence only, then there cannot be continuity of trust.** In that case we end up doubting the other person, which causes a sense of opposition in us; and since opposition is not naturally acceptable, it creates a contradiction in us. Hence the way out is to relate to the other person, to be able to see that at the level of natural acceptance we are the same. We can then interact with the person based on their competence, and also help them improve their competence.

So, you can trust anyone (for the intention part). But don't assume that his/her desires, thoughts and expectations are going to be right — he/she may lack competence. The competence is to be evaluated before you make a programme with the other.

35. What is the meaning of respect? What is the basis of respect for a human being? Do you see that the other human being is also similar to you? CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. Respect (sammana) means “Right Evaluation” — to be evaluated as I am. Usually, however, we make mistakes in evaluation in three ways:

Mistake	Meaning	Example
Over evaluation (adhi-mulyana)	To evaluate <i>more</i> than what it is	Your father tells guests, “My son is the greatest scholar in India!” — you feel uncomfortable when wrongly flattered.
Under evaluation (ava-mulyana)	To evaluate <i>less</i> than what it is	“My son is a good for nothing; he must be the laziest person in all of India!” — you feel uncomfortable when condemned.
Otherwise evaluation (a-mulyana)	To evaluate <i>otherwise</i> than what it is	“You donkey! Can't you even understand this much?” — you are evaluated as something else, since you are a human being and not something else.

Any kind of over, under or otherwise evaluation makes us uncomfortable; we feel ‘**disrespected**’. We say we have been disrespected when we are **wrongly evaluated**.

The basis for respect. A human being is a co-existence of Self (‘I’) and Body. Right evaluation is on the basis of the acceptance of this co-existence. If we respect a human being on the basis of ‘I’, the following are true for every human being:

1. I want continuous happiness and prosperity — *the other too wants to be continuously happy and prosperous.*
2. To be happy, I need to understand and live in harmony at all four levels of my living — *the other also needs to understand and live in harmony at all four levels of his/her living.*
3. The activities in me (‘I’) are continuous — we can check this for desire, thought and expectation — *it is the same for the other ‘I’ as well.*

Based on these three evaluations we conclude:

- Our **basic aspiration** is the same — we both want continuous happiness and prosperity.
- Our **programme of action** is the same — to understand and live in harmony at all four levels of our living.
- Our **potential** is the same — the activities and powers of the self are continuous and the same in both of us at the level of ‘I’.

⇒ **The other is similar to me.**

Yes — when we are able to see that the other is similar to me, we are able to recognise the feeling of respect in the relationship. If not, we either hold ourselves more or less than the other, and this only leads to **differentiation**. The difference between me and the other can only be at the level of **understanding** (not information), and this manifests as a meaningful responsibility, not as a criterion for superiority or inferiority: if the other has better understanding than me, I want to understand from the other; if the other has less understanding than me, I accept the responsibility to improve the understanding of the other.

36. How do we differentiate in relationships on the basis of body, physical facilities or beliefs? What problems do we face because of such differentiation? / “Discrimination leads to acrimony in relationships.” Explain. CIE 2 SEE Scheme 5 M

Ans. Instead of respect being a basis of *similarity* or of *right evaluation*, we have made it into something on the basis of which we **differentiate**. We differentiate on three bases:

Basis	How we differentiate	Problems created (as per the scheme)
Body	Sex/Gender — respect males more than females (or the reverse), ignoring that being male or female is an attribute of the body, not of ‘I’.	Issue of women's rights; women protesting and demanding equality in education, in jobs and in people's representation. People are insecure and afraid of one another based on their gender.
	Race — skin colour; Mongolian/Aryan/Dravidian race, or caste taken as high and low.	Many movements and protests against racial discrimination and demands for equality; racial attacks; movements against caste discrimination; people living in fear of racism, racist attacks, casteism and discrimination.
	Age — notions such as “one must respect elders”; age relates to the body, not to ‘I’.	Protests and movements demanding equal rights for children on the one hand and rights for elderly people on the other; the generation gap , a source of tension in many families.
	Physical strength — treating the stronger person differently. We think we are respecting, while it is actually fear.	Many programmes, awards and titles based on physical strength, which have nothing to do with how the person is at the level of ‘I’.
Physical facilities	Wealth — the “rich person” gets idolised; we never check whether such people feel prosperous or are happy.	Class struggle and movements to do away with class-differentiation; many people suffering from a lack of self-esteem, and some even committing suicide.
	Post — respect on the basis of a person's position; the post wrongly evaluated as the mark of excellence.	Protests against high-handed government officials. At the level of the individual, it leads to depression, since those who do not qualify for a post feel they will not get respect in society.
Beliefs	‘Isms’ — capitalism, socialism, communism, etc.; belief systems adopted since childhood.	Fights, turmoil, terrorism and war; people converting from one ‘ism’ to another in order to get more respect.
	Sects — a set of beliefs reflected in traditions and practices; only those with a similar belief system are considered ‘own’ and worthy of respect.	Countless religions and sects, each with its own movement to ensure there is no discrimination against people of their belief; demands for special provisions in jobs and in education; clashes that even turn violent.

The way out. To move beyond differentiation we have to understand the human being as the co-existence of Self (‘I’) and Body, and then base our evaluation on the Self (‘I’), where we find we are similar to the other in natural acceptance, programme of action and potential. This becomes the basis of the feeling of respect. We differ from the other only in terms of **competence**, and there we either learn from the other or take the responsibility of helping the other improve.

37. What is the difference between respect and disrespect? Which of the two is naturally acceptable to you? / List the differences between respect and differentiation. CIE 2 CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans.

Respect (Right Evaluation)	Disrespect / Differentiation
Means right evaluation — to evaluate the other as he/she is.	Means wrong evaluation — over evaluation, under evaluation, or otherwise evaluation.
Evaluation is done at the level of the Self ('I') .	Evaluation is done at the level of the Body, physical facilities or beliefs .
Based on similarity — the other is similar to me in aspiration, programme of action and potential.	Based on difference — sex, race, age, physical strength, wealth, post, 'isms', sects.
Leads to a feeling of relationship , mutual fulfilment and ease in both.	Leads to a feeling of opposition , discomfort, and problems in relationship.
It is continuous — once we have this feeling out of understanding, it remains there all the time; it is the state of harmony between one human and the other.	It is unstable and changes with the person's body, possessions or position, and hence needs constant re-establishment.
Does not require the other to do anything special; the fact that you are human is enough for me to respect you.	Makes everyone run around trying to become "special" to earn respect — which fetches only attention , not respect.
Its outcome is an undivided society .	Its outcome is a fragmented society .

Which is naturally acceptable? Respect. Verify it for yourself: what is naturally acceptable to you — the feeling of respect or disrespect for yourself? And for the other? You will find that each one of us has an acceptance for the feeling of **respect**. Just as we desire this, the other also expects the same. **Every human being wants to respect and be respected.** No human being finds disrespect acceptable in relationship.

38. Define affection. How does affection lead to harmony in the family? What is the role of physical facilities in the fulfilment of this feeling? CIE 2 5 M

Ans. Affection (sneha) is the feeling of being related to the other. Affection comes when I recognise that we both want to make each other happy and that both of us are similar. Then, for the first time, I feel that I am related to the other, that the other is a relative of mine. **“This feeling of acceptance of the other as one's relative is the feeling of affection or sneha in relationship.”**

How it leads to harmony in the family.

- This feeling comes only if **Trust and Respect are already ensured**. Without trust and respect you feel the other is trying to make you unhappy and does not wish well for you, and hence you can never feel affection for him/her; you always see the other as being in opposition. That is why in families people live together for years and still don't feel related to each other — the basic trust and respect are missing.
- When affection is there, I have come to realise that I am related to you and you are related to me. There is no doubt on intention, hence no irritation, anger or feeling of opposition — and therefore no fights. This is harmony in the family.
- Affection also removes **competition**. Competition results when there is a lack of affection. When there is affection, I **help the other grow**; when I miss this feeling, I try to beat the other and act as an opponent. What is naturally acceptable to us is **excellence**, not competition — and we humans can grow only in relationships.
- Affection is the starting point of the expansion outward: it starts with being related to *one*, and slowly expands to the feeling of being related to *everyone*, which is **love** — and this lays the basis of an undivided society.

Role of physical facilities. Affection is a feeling in 'I'; it is **not** fulfilled by physical facilities. Of the nine values, **only Care (mamata) requires physical facilities**, because care is the feeling to nurture and protect the *body* of our relative. For affection and the other feelings, what we need essentially is their **proper understanding**. Trying to express affection only by giving things is precisely the mistake of reducing relationship to the exchange of physical facilities.

39. Explain the feelings of care, guidance, reverence, glory and gratitude. 5 M

Ans.

- **Care (Mamata)** — the feeling to **nurture and protect the body of our relative**. We understand a human being as a co-existence of the Self ('I') and the Body, and the Body is an instrument of 'I'. Based on this understanding, we take the responsibility of nurturing and protecting the body of our relative. (*This is the only value that requires physical facilities.*)
- **Guidance (Vatsalya)** — the feeling of **ensuring right understanding and right feelings in the other** (my relative). We understand the need of our Self for right understanding and feelings; we also understand that the other is similar to me in the faculty of natural acceptance, in the desire for continuous happiness, and in the potential of desire, thought and expectation. Right understanding is also a need of the other, and the other is related to me; hence I have the responsibility to help the other.
- **Reverence (Shraddha)** — the feeling of **acceptance of excellence in the other**. We aspire for continuous happiness, and to realise it we must understand harmony at all levels of living and live accordingly. When we see that the other has achieved this **excellence**, we have a feeling of reverence for him/her.
- **Glory (Gaurava)** — the feeling for someone who has **made efforts for excellence**. There have been people in history, or even around us, who invest their time, energy and belongings to achieve excellence and to make others excellent. This gives us a feeling of glory for them.
- **Gratitude (Kritagyata)** — the feeling of **acceptance for those who have made effort for my excellence**. Today, what we generally call gratitude is a feeling coming out of assistance at the level of physical facilities; this feeling is **short-lived**, since the physical facility and the sensation from it are also short-lived. But gratitude coming out of someone doing something for my **right understanding is permanent**, since the happiness we get from right understanding is permanent.

40. Define love. How can you say that love is the complete value? / "The feeling of love lays down the basis of an undivided society." Explain. SEE CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. The feeling of being related to all is love (prema).

Why it is the complete value. This feeling or value is also called the **complete value (Purna mulya)**, since it is the feeling of relatedness to **all** human beings. The other values are directed towards *one* other person — affection is the feeling of being related to *the other*, care is towards *my relative's* body, guidance towards *my relative*. Love is the same feeling extended to **everyone, without exception**. Hence nothing more remains to be added; it completes the set of values in relationship. It starts with identifying that one is related to *the other* human being (the feeling of affection) and it slowly expands to the feeling of being related to *all* human beings.

Trust → being related to one (Affection) → being related to everyone (Love)

How it lays the basis of an undivided society. The feeling of love leads to an **Undivided Society (Akhanda Samaja)** — it starts from the family and slowly expands to the world family. Every human being has a natural acceptance for relatedness up to the world family in the form of love. The feeling of being related to every human being leads to our participation in an undivided society. With the understanding of values in human relationships, we are able to recognise the connectedness with every individual correctly, and fulfil it.

Conversely, if we do not understand the values in relationship, we are governed by our petty prejudices and conditionings; we treat people as high or low on the basis of body, wealth or belief. All this is a source of injustice and leads to a **fragmented** society, while our natural acceptance is for an **undivided** society and universal human order. Love is precisely the feeling that removes every basis for such fragmentation, and hence it is the foundation of the undivided society.

C. Harmony in the Society (Chapter 9)

41. What is the comprehensive human goal? Explain how this is conducive to sustainable happiness and prosperity for all. How can these four goals create harmony in society? CIE 2 CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. In order to facilitate the fulfilment of the basic aspirations of all human beings in society, the following **comprehensive human goal** needs to be understood:

#	Goal	Level	Meaning
1	Right Understanding (Samadhana)	In every individual	Right understanding is necessary for all human beings. When one does not have it, one remains disturbed and also acts so as to create disharmony with other human beings and with the rest of nature.
2	Prosperity (Samriddhi)	In every family	The family is able to identify its needs and is able to produce/achieve more than its requirements.
3	Fearlessness (Trust) (Abhaya)	In society	Every member of society feels related to everyone else, and therefore there is trust and fearlessness.
4	Co-existence (Saha-astitva)	In nature	There is a relationship and complementarity among all the entities in nature, including human beings.

How the four are related (and hence create harmony):

1. The harmony in society **begins from the individual**. We need to ensure right understanding in the individual as the foundation of harmony in society.
2. With right understanding, the **need for physical facilities in the family can be ascertained**. By assessing our needs correctly and by producing more than required, the family can be prosperous.
3. Assurance of right understanding in the individuals and prosperity in the families, together with the understanding of human relationships, leads to harmony and **trust (fearlessness) in society**. When every individual is able to live harmoniously in relationship, and the needs of all the families are ensured, fearlessness (mutual trust) in society will naturally follow.
4. When human beings with right understanding interact with nature, it will be in consonance with **co-existence** and will be mutually enriching.

1. Right Understanding → 2. Prosperity → 3. Fearlessness (trust) → 4. Co-existence

Why it is conducive to sustainable happiness and prosperity for all. With little exploration, we find that **all four are required**; we are not satisfied with anything less. This is the basic minimum requirement to ensure sustainable happiness and prosperity, and also the maximum we can think of — we cannot cut down any of them, and the moment we leave any one out, there will be a loss of continuity and the goal cannot be achieved. The goal is not only comprehensive but also **universal**, i.e. equally applicable to all human beings and for all times. Because it secures right understanding in the individual (so happiness does not depend on sensation), prosperity in the family (so the need is limited and met), fearlessness in society (so no one lives in the fear of another), and co-existence with nature (so production does not destroy its own base), the happiness and prosperity so achieved are **sustainable** rather than temporary.

42. Explain the comprehensive human goal. How does fearlessness follow from right understanding and prosperity? CIE 2 5 M

Ans. [The four constituents of the comprehensive human goal are as listed in Q41: right understanding in every individual, prosperity in every family, fearlessness (trust) in society, and co-existence in nature.]

How fearlessness follows. Fearlessness (abhaya) in society means that every member of society feels related to everyone else, and therefore there is trust and fearlessness. It follows from the first two goals in this sequence:

- **From right understanding:** With right understanding, the individual is able to recognise that relationship *is* — that it exists at the level of ‘I’ — and is able to recognise and fulfil the values in that relationship (trust, respect, affection...). Since trust means being assured that the other inherently wants my happiness and prosperity, an individual with right understanding **does not doubt the intention of the other**, and hence has no reason to fear the other. When every individual is able to live harmoniously in relationship, mutual trust in society naturally follows.
- **From prosperity:** With right understanding, the need for physical facilities in the family can be ascertained; by assessing needs correctly and producing more than required, the family becomes prosperous. A family that *feels* prosperous has no motive to exploit, hoard or grab from another family — on the contrary, the feeling of prosperity leads to **sharing** and becoming an aid to the other. Deprivation, by contrast, leads to exploiting the other. Hence when the needs of *all* the families are ensured, the basis of mutual fear between them disappears.

Thus fearlessness is not something to be manufactured separately; it is the **natural consequence** of right understanding in individuals plus prosperity in families. This is why the text states the relation as the sequence: **Right Understanding → Prosperity → Fearlessness (trust) → Co-existence.**

Contrast this with our state today: in place of working for fearlessness, we are working for **strategic powers**. In the name of defence we are misusing the valuable resources of nature to make weapons and ammunition. We are becoming increasingly more fearful of each other, paranoid that the other human being is out to get me — so most countries are busy preparing for war, in the hope that more and more competence for war will lead to peace.

43. Critically examine the state of society today in terms of the fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal. CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans.

Goal	Where we are today
Right understanding in individuals	We are not really working for this. We are talking so much about information and skills , but ignoring the need for right understanding, ignoring the need to understand happiness correctly, and ignoring the need to understand and be in relationship. The programme to ensure the very first step is missing — and the route to prosperity and social harmony is through right understanding only.
Prosperity in families	We are not able to see that the need for physical facilities is limited and that we can have more than what we need. We are only talking about how to generate more wealth . Our economy, education and market lure individuals to generate as much wealth as possible. We feel proud declaring the number of billionaires and trillionaires, without ever evaluating whether this is taking us to the state of prosperity.
Fearlessness (trust) in society	In place of working for fearlessness, we are working for strategic powers . In the name of defence we misuse the valuable resources of nature to make weapons and ammunition. We are becoming increasingly fearful of each other; most countries are busy preparing for war in the hope that more competence for war will lead to peace. We have organisations like the United Nations, but even there we do not have programmes to ensure mutual trust among people.
Co-existence with nature	Instead of co-existing, we are busy figuring out better ways to exploit nature. We have assumed that the goal of technological development is to get victory over nature, to subjugate the entities in nature and to disrupt nature's cycles. We have disregarded the obvious truth that nature is our basic support system, and that disturbing its balance will result in our own destruction.

Conclusion. We have missed out on the core things. There is a need to re-align our focus towards ensuring right understanding and relationship. For this we have to understand the harmony at all levels of our living, and move from **living with assumptions to living with right understanding**. Each one of us needs to start this journey within, to be able to contribute towards the rectification of this dangerous situation.

44. What are the five dimensions of human endeavour in society conducive to *manaviya vyavastha*? How are they helpful in achieving the comprehensive human goal? CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. These five dimensions broadly cover all the activities that are necessary and fundamental to the harmonious existence of human society:

1. **Education – Right Living (Siksha-Sanskara).** *Education* = to understand harmony at all four levels of living. *Right Living (sanskara)* = the commitment and preparedness to live in harmony at all four levels of living. This dimension ensures ‘right understanding’ and ‘right feelings’ in every individual.
2. **Health – Self-regulation (Svasthya-Sanyama).** *Sanyama* is the feeling of responsibility for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body; *Svasthya* is the state of the body when it is fit to act according to the needs of the Self and there is harmony among the parts of the body. *Sanyama* is the basis of *Svasthya*.
3. **Justice – Preservation (Nyaya-Suraksha).** *Justice* refers to harmony in the relationship between human beings — its recognition, fulfilment and evaluation leading to mutual happiness. *Preservation* refers to harmony in the relationship between the human being and the rest of nature, leading to mutual prosperity — i.e. **Enrichment (samvardhana), Protection (sanrakshana) and Right Utilization (sadupayoga)** of nature.
4. **Production – Work (Utpadana-Karya).** *Work* is the labour that the human does on the rest of nature; *Production* is the physical facility obtained out of work. Two questions matter: *what to produce?* (physical facilities for nurturing, protecting and rightly utilising the body) and *how to produce?* (through a **cyclic (avartansheel) process**, in harmony with nature, ensuring that every unit is enriched).
5. **Exchange – Storage (Vinimaya-Kosha).** *Exchange* is the exchanging of produce between members of society **for mutual fulfilment, not for the madness of profit**; *Storage* is the storing of produce after the fulfilment of needs, **with a view to right utilisation in the future, not hoarding.**

How they achieve the comprehensive human goal:

Dimension	Leads to
Education – Right Living (<i>Siksha-Sanskara</i>)	Right understanding (samadhana) in the individual
Health – Self-regulation (<i>Svasthya-Sanyama</i>)	Prosperity (samriddhi) — well-being of the body and identification of the need for physical facilities
Justice – Preservation (<i>Nyaya-Suraksha</i>)	Fearlessness (abhaya) and Co-existence (saha-astitva) respectively
Production – Work (<i>Utpadana-Karya</i>)	Prosperity and Co-existence — production is done in harmony with nature
Exchange – Storage (<i>Vinimaya-Kosha</i>)	Prosperity and Fearlessness — when we store and exchange for mutual fulfilment and not for exploitation

45. Explain how production activities can be enriching to all the orders of nature. Give any two examples. / What is the *avartansheel* process of production? CIE 2 QB 5 M

Ans. On understanding the harmony at all levels of our living, it becomes evident that there is an inherent balance in nature. So it is only natural that any production system we design is **within the framework present in nature**. When we look at the way nature is organised, two things become apparent:

1. The systems in nature are **cyclic**, i.e. they are not open-ended.
2. The systems in nature are **mutually fulfilling or mutually enriching**.

Thus the way to produce is **through a cyclical (*avartansheel*) process, in harmony with nature**: (a) it has to be cyclic, and (b) it has to ensure that every unit is enriched.

Example 1 — The seed and the soil (nature's own cycle). When a seed is planted in soil and water is added, it grows into a tree and in turn bears leaves, flowers and fruits. The fruits ripen, leaves mature and fall to the ground and enrich the soil, forming manure by decaying. Seeds are scattered from the fruit into the soil and once again form a plant and bear fruit. This way the soil gets enriched, seeds are multiplied and the tree grows — everything is regenerated. The process is both cyclic and enriching.

Example 2 — Extending the cycle: guava and jam. Guavas grow in nature; we eat them and finally the residue goes back to the soil through human excreta. We can *extend* this process by making jam or jelly out of guava and eating the jam. This making of jam is **production**, which is essentially an extension of the cyclic production process already taking place in nature.

Example 3 — Wood and trees. The amount of wood one person would require in a lifetime can be obtained from about four full-grown trees. How many trees can a person plant in a lifetime? Certainly more than four — it can even be ten, twenty or a hundred. So, if aware, a human being can be enriching for nature in a much more effective manner than an animal can.

What we do instead. While nature's processes are all cyclic (close-ended), our processes are **acyclic** (open-ended) and deplete resources. When we burn coal, it is a non-renewable resource — we can never again produce it. The utility of the fossil fuels at the bottom of the earth is to keep the temperature on the earth's surface in a steady state; by depleting them we tamper with the earth's ability to maintain its temperature, which is an irreparable damage. And burning them in enormous quantities pollutes the atmosphere and poisons the air we breathe. Similarly, on **enriching** we largely fare 'NO': land that has seen heavy use of chemical fertilisers becomes unfit for agriculture, and pesticides poison our own bodies as well as animals and birds.

46. Describe the concept of an undivided society and the universal human order, and explain how both can help create a world family. CIE 2 QB SEE 5 M

Ans.

Undivided Society (Akhanda Samaja) — the feeling of being related to **every human being**.

Universal Human Order (Sarvabhauma Vyavastha) — the feeling of being related to **every unit**, including human beings and the other entities of nature.

Undivided society. Harmony in the family is the building block for harmony in society, and harmony in society leads to an undivided society when we feel related to each and every human being. Today our feelings for our society have become very limited and each one of us lives in a very small web of relationships. Our natural acceptance, however, is for relatedness with all, and we can very naturally expand into the world family. The feeling of being related to every human being — i.e. **love**, the complete value — leads to our participation in an undivided society. With the understanding of values in human relationships, we are able to recognise the connectedness with every individual correctly, and fulfil it.

Universal human order. When we understand the values in relationship with the other units in nature too, we are able to recognise our connectedness with them and fulfil it. This enables us to participate in the universal human order. Having understood the comprehensive human goal, we are able to be in harmony not only with human beings but also with the rest of nature; we see that we are related to every unit in nature and ensure mutual fulfilment in that relationship.

How both help create a world family. Working on the five dimensions of human endeavour in the light of right understanding, we are able to work for an **orderly living of human society, whose foundational unit is the family and whose final destination is the world family**. Thus a number of family units in the form of a village, and a number of villages, integrate into larger clusters of human society — expanding in this sequence finally to a universal human order on this planet. Living in this order, we are able to plan for the need of physical facilities, the availability of natural resources and the role of human beings in ensuring the need at the level of the planet. We are able to work for the inculcation of universally acceptable human values through education, plan systems to ensure justice for all human beings, and make policies for the well-being of all.

Individual → Family → Society → Nature/Existence ≡ Family order → World family order

47. Right understanding in the individuals is the basis for harmony in the family, which is the building block for harmony in the society. Give your comments. CIE 2 QB Scheme 5 M

Ans. Right understanding in the individuals is the basis for harmony in the family, which is the building block for harmony in the society.

1. The harmony in the society **begins from the individual**. We need to ensure right understanding in the individual as the foundation of harmony in the society.
2. With right understanding, the **need for physical facilities in the family can be ascertained**. By assessing our needs correctly and by producing more than required, the family can be prosperous.
3. Assurance of right understanding in the individuals and prosperity in the families, and the understanding of human relationships, leads to **harmony and trust (fearlessness) in the society**. When every individual is able to live harmoniously in relationship, and the needs of all the families are ensured, fearlessness (mutual trust) in society will naturally follow.
4. When human beings with right understanding interact with nature, it will be in consonance with the **co-existence** and will be mutually enriching.

We may also understand it in the following sequence:

1. Right understanding → 2. Prosperity → 3. Fearlessness (trust) → 4. Co-existence

48. What is the role of the value system in family harmony? / Explain the difference between response and reaction. SEE 5 M

Ans. The values (feelings) in relationship are **definite** and can be recognised. Their recognition, fulfilment and evaluation lead to **mutual happiness** — which is exactly what justice in the family means. Living with these feelings is our innate need; problems arise in relationships because we are unable to ensure the **continuity** of these feelings.

The role of the value system in family harmony can be seen from the following:

- Relationship is **already there**; it does not have to be created. It only needs to be **understood and fulfilled** accordingly — and the value system is precisely what allows us to recognise and fulfil it.
- **Trust** is the foundation value. If trust — the adhara mulya — is shaken, then the whole relationship is disturbed. The problem today is that even in families we doubt each other, with the result that we behave like enemies, we try to put the other person down, and there is a breakdown of relationship.
- The **basic** values to be understood in relationship are **trust and respect**. If we have these, the remaining values (affection, care, guidance, reverence, glory, gratitude, love) flow quite naturally, and harmony in the family is ensured.

Response vs. reaction. If we look at our living today, it is largely in the **reaction** mode and not in the **response** mode:

Reaction	Response
Doubt on intention	We are able to see that relationship IS, at the level of 'I'
Irritation	We feel the relatedness with the other at the level of 'I'
Getting angry	We don't doubt the intention of the other 'I'
Fights	We feel a sense of responsibility to improve our own competence and the other's competence; we work for mutual fulfilment

For want of proper understanding of relationships, we keep *reacting* to the behaviour of the other person and are at the mercy of the situation. Only when we recognise the relationships in terms of appropriate values do we *respond* to every situation and to every person in the right way.

49. How can exchange of physical goods be mutually fulfilling? Evaluate the motivation of exchange in today's scenario. Why is storage required? 5 M

Ans. Exchange (vinimaya) refers to the exchange of physical facilities between the members of society; **storage (kosha)** refers to the storage of physical facilities that is left after fulfilling the needs of the family.

Exchange — exchanging of produce for **mutual fulfilment** (with a view to mutual fulfilment, *not the madness of profit*).

Storage — storing of produce after fulfilment of needs (with a view to **right utilisation in future**, *not hoarding*).

How exchange can be mutually fulfilling. Each family has the capacity to produce more than what it needs for itself. If a family produces wheat, it can produce for ten families together; another family can similarly produce cotton for its whole neighbourhood. Summing up all the needs in society, families are capable of producing **more than the need**. And then we can exchange things — in the form of commodities themselves, or through currency wherever required. We are exchanging so that **all of us are able to fulfil our needs together**. As soon as we are able to recognise the relationship with the other human being or with the rest of nature, we cannot think of exploiting anything.

Why storage is required. When we produce more than required, we exchange for our current needs and store for future needs. This storage is to be used when production is not taking place, or when some relative of ours needs it. It is for the **proper utilisation of the physical facility in the future**, not with a view to hoard.

Motivation of exchange today. We have developed efficient ways of selling and buying, sending or receiving money, and investing it to multiply faster than nature ever could. Sitting with a laptop we can purchase commodities across the world and invest capital in distant markets; profits can multiply overnight and one can enter the list of trillionaires without any physical work; we can store hoards of currency within a digital map. But with these rising modes of exchange and storage, the **exploitation of mankind and nature has shot up**. The disparities in wealth have increased, and the **madness for profit has become the general motivation**. Liquidity of money has of course provided a smooth mode of exchange, but it has created more problems than solutions. These problems are the outcome of our mis-perception in visualising **money**, which is a *notional* entity, to be the same as **physical facilities**, which are tangible and are our real needs. It needs to be remembered that **money is not a need in itself but only a mechanism to facilitate the exchange of physical facilities**.

Understanding Harmony in Nature and Existence

A. Nature, Harmony and the Four Orders

50. Define harmony in nature. Why is it important? Explain with examples.

SEE

CIE 3 QB

5 M

Ans. Nature is the combination of all that is in the solid, liquid or gas state; in other words, the **aggregate of all the mutually interacting units — big or small, sentient or insentient — together can be called nature.**

These units are infinite in number, and we could easily observe that there exists a **dynamic balance, a self-regulation** among all these units. **This self-regulation is harmony or balance in nature.**

The law of nature has a unique cause-and-effect system which must be understood in order to be in harmony with the natural law of things. Natural harmony is necessary for the following reasons:

1. It is necessary to solve the problem of **global warming**, and the depletion of non-renewable natural resources can be avoided.
2. Natural harmony with **trees** cures many problems — reduction of wind velocity, energy savings, companion planting, development of an eco-subsystem in terms of establishing a forest garden, and reduction of building heat.
3. It is possible to achieve natural harmony in the establishment, maintenance and management of educational institutions like schools, colleges and universities.
4. One can understand the depths of harmony and alignment in nature by contemplating and reflecting upon the natural order. It is possible to unravel the mystery of the natural synthesis in the midst of ongoing chaos at the material plane.

How to create it. First of all we have to understand the importance of nature for our existence, and then our responsibility towards nature. When we take from nature, we should also plan to give back to it. Renewable energy sources such as solar power and wind are perhaps the best methods to begin moving in this direction. There can be harmony only if each subsystem of the entire creation can strike a mutually satisfying relationship with every other subsystem, without disturbing the other's peaceful existence and without hindering its own growth. To create harmony in nature, we have to work in the direction of the development of mankind **from animal consciousness to human consciousness** — and this entails working for the **right understanding.**

51. What are the four orders of nature? Briefly explain them.

CIE 3

SEE

Scheme

5 M

Ans. All the physical objects in the solid, liquid or gas state, living or non-living, are collectively termed nature — the aggregate of all mutually interacting units, big or small, sentient or insentient. These units are infinite in number and there exists a dynamic balance and self-regulation among them. The concept of the four orders provides a framework for understanding the natural world as an **interconnected system composed of distinct yet interdependent categories**:

1. **Material Order (Padartha Avastha / Bhautik Avastha).** The big land masses of the continents, gigantic water bodies like oceans and seas, mountains and rivers, the atmosphere above, the heaps of metals and minerals below, the dense gases and fossil fuels deep below the surface of the earth — all fall into the material order. Beyond the earth it is visible as stars, planets, moons and several astronomical bodies. It comprises all **non-living** elements — soil, water, air, minerals and other inanimate objects — and forms the foundational base for all other forms of life. It follows natural laws like gravitation, thermodynamics and chemical reactions; these elements are stable and do not possess the ability to grow or reproduce.
2. **Pranic / Plant / Bio Order (Prana Avastha / Jeevan Avastha).** Our land mass is covered with grass and small shrubs which form the lining on the entire soil; shrubs, plants and trees form huge forests, along with the flora in the ocean. This order includes all **living but non-conscious** entities — plants, trees and other vegetation. It is responsible for sustaining life by producing oxygen, absorbing carbon dioxide, and providing food and shelter to animals and humans. It is characterised by growth, reproduction and the ability to interact with the environment through processes like photosynthesis. However, it does **not** have self-awareness.
3. **Animal Order (Jeeva Avastha / Chetan Avastha).** Animals and birds form the third largest order. It includes all **conscious living beings** — animals, birds, insects and other creatures that possess sensory abilities. Animals play a crucial role in maintaining ecological balance by being part of the food chain, aiding in pollination, seed dispersal and other natural processes. The animal order is characterised by **instincts, sensory perception and consciousness**. Animals can experience pleasure, pain and emotions, but are primarily driven by instincts rather than rational thinking.
4. **Human / Knowledge Order (Manav Avastha / Gyana Avastha).** Humans are the smallest order. The human order encompasses all human beings, who are conscious, **self-aware and capable of rational thought**. Humans have the unique ability to reflect on their actions, make ethical decisions, create culture and innovate. They also have the responsibility to nurture and maintain harmony among the other orders. The human order is defined by self-awareness, the ability to think rationally, creativity, and the pursuit of knowledge.

(Note the relative quantity: the material order is far greater than the plant/bio order, which is far greater than the animal order, which is far greater than the human order.)

Conclusion. The four orders of nature — physical, bio, animal and human — are interconnected and interdependent. Each order plays a vital role in maintaining the balance and harmony of the natural world. Understanding these orders helps us appreciate the complexity of existence and encourages responsible and sustainable living.

52. What are the four orders in nature? Describe their activity, innateness, natural characteristic, basic activity and conformance. CIE 3 QB 8–10 M

Ans. The four orders can be distinctly recognised in terms of the following five parameters:

	Material Order	Pranic / Plant / Bio Order	Animal Order	Human Order
Things	Soil, air, water, metals, minerals	Plants, herbs, trees; animal bodies and human bodies	Animal body + 'I'	Human body + 'I'
Activity (Kriya)	Composition / Decomposition	Composition / Decomposition + Respiration	<i>Body</i> : Composition / Decomposition, Respiration <i>I'</i> : + Selection (assuming)	<i>Body</i> : Composition / Decomposition, Respiration <i>I'</i> : Desiring, Thinking, Selecting — with the possibility of Realization & Understanding
Innateness (Dharana)	Existence	Existence + Growth	(Existence + Growth) in body + Will to live in 'I'	(Existence + Growth) in body + Will to live with happiness in 'I'
Natural Characteristic (Svabhava)	Composition / Decomposition	Composition / Decomposition + Nurture / Worsen	(Comp./Decomp., Nurture/Worsen) in body + Non-cruelty / Cruelty in 'I'	(Comp./Decomp., Nurture/Worsen) in body + Perseverance, Bravery, Generosity in 'I'
Basic Activity	Recognising, Fulfilment	Recognising, Fulfilment	<i>Body</i> : Recognising, Fulfilment <i>I'</i> : Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilment	<i>Body</i> : Recognising, Fulfilment <i>I'</i> : Knowing , Assuming, Recognising, Fulfilment
Conformance (Anushangita)	Constitution conformance	Seed conformance	Breed conformance	Sanskar conformance

This single table is the highest-yield thing to memorise for Unit III — most Unit III questions are a row or a column of it.

53. What do you mean by ‘innateness’ (*dharana*)? What is the innateness in the four orders?

CIE 3 QB

5 M

Ans. Innateness (*dharana*) means the qualities which are innate to the unit. Each unit in existence exhibits an innateness, an intrinsic quality that **cannot be separated from it**. This is intrinsic to the unit.

- **Material order — Existence.** When we burn coal and only some ash is left and the smoke has gone out, it is not that the fundamental particles in the coal have “ceased to exist”. They may not be visible to the eye at that moment, but they continue to exist in the form of other matter or gases. We cannot destroy matter; we can only convert it from one form to another. Thus **“to exist”** is intrinsic to all material — we cannot separate the ‘existence’ of a thing from the thing itself.
- **Pranic / plant order — Existence + Growth.** Because the pranic order is a development of the material order, it also has the innateness of ‘existence’. In addition it exhibits **‘growth’**. This principle cannot be separated from any unit of this order: if you have a plant, you cannot stop it from growing. The only way to stop it is by cutting it — but when you do that, it ceases to belong to the pranic order and, instead, decays and belongs to the material order.
- **Animal order — Existence + Growth + Will to live.** The animal body is a development of the pranic order and therefore inherits ‘existence’ and ‘growth’ at the level of the body, which is physico-chemical in nature. In addition, all units in this order have the **‘will to live’** in ‘I’. No unit in this order can be separated from this will to live.
- **Human (knowledge) order — Existence + Growth + Will to live with happiness.** In the human being, ‘existence’ and ‘growth’ are fundamentally present in the body, just as in the animal body. At the level of ‘I’, however, in addition to the ‘will to live’, a human being’s innateness is the **‘will to live with happiness’**.

54. What is the natural characteristic (svabhava) of a unit? Explain the svabhava of the human order and how it helps in living with harmony. CIE 3 SEE Scheme 5 M

Ans. When we look at the different orders in nature, we find that each order has a certain **value** — in a fundamental way, this is the ‘**usefulness**’ or ‘**participation**’ of the order in existence. This value or participation is also referred to as the **natural characteristic** or **svabhava**. The characteristic the order displays is *natural to itself*.

Order	Svabhava
Material order	Composition / decomposition
Pranic / plant order	Composition / decomposition, and to nurture or worsen other pranic units
Animal order	<i>Body:</i> composition / decomposition, nurture / worsen <i>T:</i> non-cruelty (akrurata) and cruelty (krurata) . Cruelty means the feeling that it can fulfil its needs through violence and forcefulness. Cows may largely live with non-cruelty, while tigers and lions may exhibit cruelty.
Human order	<i>Body:</i> composition / decomposition, nurture / worsen <i>T:</i> perseverance (dhirata), bravery (virata) and generosity (udarata)

Svabhava of the human order in detail. As in the case of animals, the human body also belongs to the plant/bio order and hence has the same svabhava as the pranic order — it either nurtures or worsens other pranic units. (When I digest a vegetable, I absorb the plant and it worsens, while my body is nurtured.) The svabhava of the self (‘I’) in human beings is:

- **Perseverance (dhirata)** — being assured that the all-encompassing solution is to understand and live in harmony at all levels of existence, and living with this commitment **without any perturbation**.
- **Bravery (virata)** — being assured of this solution, and being **ready to help the other have the right understanding**. This is the commitment to help the other understand harmony and to live at all levels of existence.
- **Generosity (udarata)** — being assured of this solution, and being **ready to invest myself, my body and my wealth** to help the other have the right understanding.

How this helps in living with harmony. Human beings are **not** living as per this natural characteristic; even though we have a svabhava, we are not living according to it. This is the basic reason for the contradiction and conflict that we see in the human being, and what leads to a state of unhappiness. Only when we live according to our basic human characteristics as mentioned above do we have a **definite character**; otherwise it is not definite, it is uncertain — unlike the other three orders, which are always according to their svabhava.

The 2024 CIE 3 scheme expresses the same idea in general terms: the svabhava of the human order revolves around **self-awareness and consciousness, the desire for knowledge and understanding, the ability to make rational decisions, the aspiration for justice and ethics, and creativity and innovation**. These qualities set humans apart from other beings and empower them to contribute meaningfully to the harmony and well-being of the world. Either formulation is acceptable; the textbook triad (dhirata, virata, udarata) is the safer answer.

55. What do you mean by ‘conformance’? Explain the conformance in the four orders.

CIE 3 QB

5 M

Ans. Each unit conforms through the principle of **conformance (anushangita)**. It means **how the continuity of the fundamental nature of the unit is preserved**.

- **Material order — Constitution conformance.** The continuity of the fundamental nature of a material unit is preserved through physical and chemical processes. Take iron: each atom of iron conforms to the constitutional structure of ‘iron’. There is no atom of iron that will be unlike another atom of iron — if it were, we would not call it iron. The same holds for oxygen, nitrogen, gold, silver, aluminium: all conform to the constitution of their kind.
- **Plant / bio order — Seed conformance.** A neem seed will always sprout a neem plant. Its fruits, its leaves, the taste and colour of the leaves — all this basic information of every neem plant is stored in the seed. Thus the plant is always as the seed: *“as the seed, thus the plant”*. This seed-conformance method is the mechanism by which the continuity of a plant species is maintained in nature/existence.
- **Animal order — Breed conformance.** A cow is always like a cow, and a dog is always like a dog. Animals conform to their **lineage** — how animals are, and their behaviour, is according to the lineage they come from. This breed-conformance method is the mechanism by which the continuity of an animal species is maintained in nature/existence.
- **Human (knowledge) order — Sanskar conformance.** We humans are **not** according to our lineage or race, as animals are. We may pick up something from our parents as we grow up, but we are usually very different from them in many ways. We humans are according to our **imagination** — according to our desires, thoughts and selections in ‘I’. These can come from past memories, our parents, the environment, the media — anywhere. In the case of humans we can say *“as the education, so the human”*. Together we call these **sanskara**; hence a human being conforms to his or her sanskar.

56. How is the activity in the human order different from that in the animal and plant order? Explain the activity in the four orders. CIE 3 QB 5 M

Ans. An **activity** means something that 'has motion' and/or 'has a result'. We can understand this in two ways: things that are **visibly moving** (a spinning top, a moving bus) are active; and things that are **visibly stationary** are *also* active — e.g. the activity of a chair is that the wood is interacting with the environment and, as a result, decays with time. All units around us, including ourselves, are active all the time; in the activity there is a state or configuration and motion simultaneously.

- **Material order.** All material things can be understood as an activity of units coming together to form a bigger unit — **composition** (e.g. a chair made of smaller pieces of wood). Bigger units can also separate to form smaller units — **decomposition** (a wooden chair decays after a few years). Thus any unit in the material order is an activity of **composition/decomposition**.
- **Plant / bio order. Composition/decomposition + respiration.** Not only do plants compose (forming new plants) and decompose (decaying), they are also breathing or pulsating, which we call respiration.
- **Animal order.** Two aspects:
Body — *physico-chemical activities*: the body displays the same activities as the plant — composition/decomposition and respiration; hence we say the body belongs to the plant/bio order.
'I' — *conscious activities*: 'I' is a unit that has the ability of **assuming**. Animals make assumptions. If we have a dog and a stranger comes into the house, the dog may start barking at him. If this person stays at our house, the dog may stop barking at him but will continue to bark at other strangers. The dog's **assumption** about this person has changed, due to which the way it responds has changed. This consciousness or faculty of assuming is **not** in the body; the body belongs to the plant/bio order and just responds to physico-chemical inputs.
- **Human (knowledge) order.** The activities in the human body are similar to those in the animal body — composition/decomposition and respiration. When it comes to consciousness or 'I', however, the human displays **more** than just an ability to select or make choices as animals do. In human beings, 'I' has the activities of **desiring, thinking, and selecting/tasting, with a possibility or need for realization and understanding. Only humans have this need to know**, and that is why it is called **gyana avastha — the knowledge order**.

Basic activity. In the material and pranic orders there is only **recognising and fulfilment**; such units do not have the activities of assuming and knowing. Hydrogen and oxygen recognise the relation to each other and combine to form water. A brick and another brick have a definite relation, recognise it, and get arranged to form a building. A plant recognises the relation with sun and water and fulfils it by acting accordingly. There is no **selection** involved — a plant does not choose to turn or not to turn to the sun. When we look at animals and humans, we find **selection** taking place; in animals there is additionally **assuming**, and in humans there is additionally **knowing**.

57. Explain the difference and similarities between the Pranic order and the Animal order. What is the relation between the two orders? CIE 3 Scheme 5 M

Ans.

Pranic Order (Bio Order)	Animal Order
All forms of plant life, including trees, shrubs, grasses and other vegetation.	All animal species, including humans, mammals, birds, reptiles, fish, insects and others.
Lacks conscious awareness and sensory perception; operates primarily on biological and chemical processes.	Possesses conscious awareness , sensory perception and instincts; animals can perceive their environment, feel pain, and respond to stimuli.
Engages in growth, reproduction, photosynthesis and other life-sustaining processes without the need for consciousness or decision-making.	Engages in instinct-driven behaviours such as hunting, mating and social interaction, guided by sensory input and biological needs.
Relies on sunlight, water and nutrients from the soil to produce energy through photosynthesis.	Relies on consuming plants (herbivores) or other animals (carnivores) for energy.
Typically stationary , with movements limited to growth or response to environmental stimuli (e.g. plants growing towards light).	Typically mobile , with the ability to move from one place to another in search of food, shelter or mates.

Similarities:

1. **Life processes:** both orders are living entities that undergo biological processes such as growth, reproduction and respiration.
2. **Interdependence:** both are interconnected and interdependent within ecosystems. Plants provide oxygen and food for animals, while animals contribute to plant reproduction through pollination, seed dispersal and nutrient cycling.
3. **Ecological roles:** both play crucial roles in maintaining ecological balance. Plants are primary producers, converting sunlight into energy, while animals often act as consumers, maintaining the balance of populations within ecosystems.

Relation between the two orders:

1. The **animal body is a development of the pranic order** — the body of the animal belongs to the plant/bio order and hence has the same ‘usefulness’ or value (nurture/worsen) as the pranic order. Consequently, the animal order inherits the innateness of the pranic order — **existence and growth** — and, in addition, has the **will to live** in ‘I’.
2. The Pranic Order can therefore be seen as the broader concept encompassing the life force that animates living bodies, while the Animal Order is the **co-existence of that pranic body with the self (‘I’)**. In this way the Pranic Order provides a more holistic view that includes the scientific categorisation found in the Animal Order.

58. Explain the differences and similarities between the animal order and the human order. What is the relation between the two? CIE 3 QB 5 M

Ans. Both orders are the **co-existence of a body (pranic order) and the self ('I' = consciousness)**. The animal order is the co-existence of the animal body and 'I'; the human order is the co-existence of the human body and 'I'. That is the fundamental similarity, and the body-level activities (composition/decomposition and respiration) are identical in both. The differences are entirely at the level of 'I':

Parameter	Animal Order	Human Order
Activity in 'I'	Assuming — the dog that stops barking at a person who stays in the house, but keeps barking at other strangers, has changed its <i>assumption</i> .	Desiring, thinking, selecting/tasting , with a possibility or need for realization and understanding . Only humans have this need to know — hence <i>gyana avastha</i> .
Innateness	Existence + growth (body) + will to live ('I')	Existence + growth (body) + will to live with happiness ('I')
Svabhava	Nurture/worsen (body) + non-cruelty / cruelty ('I')	Nurture/worsen (body) + perseverance, bravery, generosity ('I')
Basic activity	Recognising, fulfilment (body); assuming , recognising, fulfilment ('I')	Recognising, fulfilment (body); knowing , assuming, recognising, fulfilment ('I')
Conformance	Breed conformance — a cow is always like a cow, a dog always like a dog; behaviour is according to lineage.	Sanskar conformance — we are according to our desires, thoughts and selections, which can come from memories, parents, environment or media. <i>"As the education, so the human."</i>
Definiteness of conduct	Definite — the animal is always according to its breed.	Not definite today — because we are not living according to our svabhava; this is the basic reason for contradiction and conflict in the human being.

Relation. The human order is a further development of the animal order: the human body belongs to the plant/bio order just as the animal body does, and the human inherits existence, growth and the will to live. What is *added* in the human order is the activity of **knowing**, and correspondingly the innateness of the **will to live with happiness**. This addition is precisely what makes the human being responsible for maintaining harmony among the other three orders.

B. Interconnectedness, Recyclability and Self-organisation

59. How will you show interconnectedness and mutual fulfilment in the four orders of nature with examples? How is the human order responsible to the other three orders? CIE 3 QB 5 M

Ans. In nature, all the units are connected to each other and fulfilling each other. A human being is related to all other human beings, and is connected to all the material units in existence, becoming aware of it as he/she starts exploring.

- **Material order and Plant/Bio order.** The material order provides the nutrients to the plant/bio order in the form of soil, minerals, etc., while the plant/bio order decays and forms more nutrients, thus enriching the soil. The plant/bio order also decays into substances like oil and coal, stored deep within the earth as protection against the heat from the molten core and from the sun. Plants help move the nutrients through the various layers of the soil; the roots hold the soil together and prevent erosion; plants produce oxygen/carbon dioxide and thus help in the movement of the material order. There is mutual interdependency and co-existence here.
- **Material, Plant/Bio and Animal orders.** The material order provides the basis for the movement of all animals, birds and fishes. Water, oxygen and other gases are necessities for both plants and animals. At the same time, the animal order helps enrich the soil with its excreta, which gives nutrients to plants. The plant/bio order provides food for animals, birds and fishes; the animal order helps in the pollination of the flowers of the pranic order.
- **All four orders including the Human order.** We humans also have a natural acceptance to be mutually fulfilling to these three orders. **However, we are not able to ensure this mutual fulfilment.** We are dependent on the material order for soil, minerals and metals, but only end up polluting the soil and depleting the fossil fuels. We are dependent on plants for our food and for holding together the larger ecosystem, but we have destroyed forests and multiple species of plants and herbs. We are dependent on animals to carry out our production and transportation activities, but have made many species extinct, and are today known for our cruelty towards animals.

Conclusion. We can see that there is interconnectedness and mutual fulfilment in all the orders of nature **except the human order. We have to work on this.** The purpose of science and technology is to facilitate the cyclic processes in nature and make human beings more and more fulfilling to the other entities. If we understand the processes in nature, we can design our production systems through the application of science and technology in such a way that this mutual fulfilment is better ensured, rather than disturbed.

60. Explain how there is recyclability and self-regulation in nature, with examples. How is it useful for sustainable production? CIE 3 QB 5 M

Ans. There are several **cyclical processes** that we can see in nature. For example, the cycle of water — evaporating, condensing and precipitating back to water, giving the weather phenomena. The cycles keep these materials **self-regulated** on the earth.

Examples of self-regulation:

- **Forest:** the growth of trees takes place in a way such that the amount of soil, plants and animals remains conserved. It never happens that the number of trees shoots up and there is a lack of soil for the trees. The appropriateness of the conditions for the growth of both plants and animals is self-regulated in nature, keeping the population proportions naturally maintained.
- **Breeds:** in a single breed of animals, the number of males and females generated through procreation is such that the continuity of the species is ensured by itself. (This happens with humans too, but inhuman practices have led to disproportionate numbers of men and women.)

These two characteristics — **cyclical nature and self-regulation** — provide us with clues of the harmony that is in nature.

Usefulness for sustainable production. Since nature's systems are cyclic and mutually enriching, our production systems must be designed within that framework — i.e. the **avartansheel (cyclical) process**, which is cyclic and ensures that every unit is enriched. Our processes today are **acyclic** (open-ended) and deplete resources: when we burn coal we can never again produce it, and burning it in enormous quantities pollutes the atmosphere. Recognising recyclability and self-regulation tells us *how* to produce — extend the production system already inherently present in nature, so that resources are continuously renewed and replenished, and production becomes sustainable rather than depleting.

61. How can we say that ‘nature is self-organised and in space self-organisation is available’? CIE 3

SEE

Scheme

5 M

Ans. Every unit is an organisation. A unit recognises other units and combines to form a bigger organisation. Starting from the atom to the big galaxy, this organisation goes on, as a **self-organisation**. At every level we get a self-organisation: sub-atomic particles recognise each other and come together to form atoms; cells recognise each other and form organisations like organs and a body; planetary bodies, solar systems and galaxies are still bigger organisations. **We are not organising it. We are not supplying it organisation from outside.**

In the human being. We are self-organised at the level of the **body** — we are not doing anything for the coordination between the heart, kidneys, lungs, eyes, brain, hands and legs; all these function together. Our input is needed only to provide the required nutrition and to assist the body when we fall sick or get injured. At the level of ‘**I**’, however, we are **not** self-organised — but, being in space, **self-organisation is available** to the self. That is why we are in pursuit of happiness, which is essentially being in harmony; whenever we are not in harmony, we are unhappy.

All the units of the four orders are self-organised. No one is organising them from outside; no one is supplying this organisation. This self-organisation is available to units **being in space**. Hence, for space, we say “**self-organisation is available**”.

Supporting points (from the CIE 3 scheme):

- **Natural balance:** ecosystems regulate themselves through food chains, nutrient cycles and population-control mechanisms, ensuring that no single species dominates to the detriment of others.
- **Autonomous processes:** the water cycle, the carbon cycle and the growth of plants occur without external intervention, governed by natural laws.
- **Feedback mechanisms:** predator–prey relationships keep animal populations in check; plants adjust their growth based on the availability of sunlight and nutrients.
- **Role of space:** space is not just a void but an all-encompassing entity that provides the medium for everything to exist and interact. It allows for the free movement of energy, matter and information, and provides the context within which natural laws operate.
- **Resilience and adaptation:** ecosystems recover from disturbances such as fires or floods through natural regeneration, guided by the inherent organisation within nature.

C. Existence as Co-existence

62. Define existence. “Existence is co-existence of mutually interacting units in all-pervasive space.”

Explain. CIE 3 SEE Scheme 5 M

Ans. All the units together constitute **nature**. All the units of nature exist in **space**, which is an important reality to understand. **Existence is nothing but nature submerged in space.**

Existence = Space + Units (in space)

Since nature consists of the four orders, “**Existence = Nature submerged in space**”, where Nature = the four orders (Material, Plant/Bio or Pranic, Animal and Human Order).

A **unit** is something that is limited in size — from a small blade of hair to the biggest planets, all are limited in size, i.e. bounded on six sides. We can recognise them; they are countable. But there is another reality called **space**. We normally don't pay attention to it because it is not a unit — we can't touch it or smell it, we just see through it. But the fact that we can't touch it does not mean it does not exist. Space exists everywhere. When we look at existence around us, the first thing we see is space; then we see the units in space, and between every two units there is space.

Explaining the statement (as per the CIE 3 scheme). Existence is fundamentally the co-existence of various units that interact with one another within the infinite expanse of space. Each unit — whether it is a physical entity like a rock, a biological entity like a plant, or a conscious being like a human — is **not isolated**; rather, it exists in relation to and interacts with other units.

1. **Co-existence:** all entities or units, be they material or living, do not exist in isolation. They inherently exist together, forming a cohesive whole. This concept highlights the interconnectedness of all elements in the universe.
2. **Mutual interaction:** units in existence are in constant interaction with one another. These interactions are governed by natural laws that ensure balance and harmony within the system. For example, plants (bio order) interact with the physical environment (soil, water) and animals, facilitating the flow of energy and matter.
3. **All-pervasive space:** space is not merely an empty void but the foundation in which all units exist and interact. It is all-pervasive, meaning it is present everywhere, allowing these interactions to occur seamlessly.
4. **Holistic perspective:** the idea of co-existence emphasises a holistic view of the universe, where the well-being of each unit is tied to the well-being of the whole. Disruptions in this balance can lead to disharmony, affecting the entire system.
5. **Sustainability:** recognising existence as co-existence leads to an understanding of the need for sustainable living. When humans acknowledge their role as part of this interconnected system, they are more likely to engage in practices that promote balance and harmony.

In conclusion, existence is a dynamic process of co-existence where all units, through their interactions within the vast expanse of space, contribute to the overall harmony of the universe. This perspective encourages us to live in a way that respects and nurtures these connections. **Existence is in the form of co-existence. It is in harmony. We don't have to create this harmony — it already exists. We only have to understand it to be in it.**

63. What do you mean by co-existence? SEE CIE 2/3 QB 4 M

Ans. Co-existence in nature means there is a relationship and complementarity among all the entities in nature, including human beings. Co-existence is a state in which two or more groups are living together while respecting their differences and resolving their conflicts non-violently. It has been defined in numerous ways:

1. To exist together (in time or space) and to exist in mutual tolerance.
2. To learn to recognise and live with difference.
3. To have a relationship between persons or groups in which none of the parties is trying to destroy the other.
4. To exist together (in time or place) and to exist in mutual tolerance.

The world is full of diversity — there are different nations, cultures, religions, communities, languages and beliefs. The beauty of existence can only be maximised if everything in this world is in harmony. **Peaceful, symbiotic co-existence is the key to harmony in the world.**

Co-existence (*saha-astitva*) is also the fourth constituent of the **comprehensive human goal** — co-existence *in nature*. In the context of coexistence, ‘prosperity’ means **holistic well-being and happiness**, not material wealth accumulation.

64. Define the terms *Gathansheel*, *Gathanpurna*, *Kriyapurnata* and *Acharanpurnata*. Explain the holistic perception of harmony in existence. CIE 3 QB 5 M

Ans.

Term	Meaning
Gathansheel	The material units are transformable , and their composition keeps on changing — hence these are <i>gathansheel</i> .
Gathanpurna	The other category of units, the sentient ‘I’, do not transform and are complete in composition — hence <i>gathanpurna</i> .
Kriyapurnata	Completion of right understanding in the human being.
Acharanpurnata	The ability to live with complete understanding .

Holistic perception of harmony in existence. Existence is units in space. Space is the empty area all around. The units are of two types: **material (insentient)** and **conscious (the sentient ‘I’)**. The material units are changeful (with the activities of recognising and fulfilment only), while the other kind of units are continuous (with the activities of knowing, assuming, recognising and fulfilment).

The material units are available in two orders — **material order** and **pranic order**. In the material order, an atom combines with another atom to form a molecule; a molecule similarly forms a molecular structure. Molecular structures are found in two forms: **lumps and fluids**. Fluids give nutrition to the pranic order. In the pranic order, the smallest units are **plant cells**, which combine with other cells to form plants, animal bodies and human bodies. The **co-existence of ‘I’ with the animal body becomes the animal order**, and the **co-existence of ‘I’ with the human body becomes the human order**.

On the material side, the transformation keeps taking place and it is **cyclic** in nature. On the side of the sentient ‘I’, the transitions are **acyclic**. This implies that what we have understood *continues to stay with us* — we will never miss it. This is a transition in one direction, and this is actually called **development (vikas)**.

So, existence is in the form of co-existence; it is in harmony. We don't have to create this harmony — it already exists; we only have to understand it in order to be in it. This means that having the knowledge of the self (‘I’) gives me the knowledge of **humane conduct** — how to live in existence, with the four orders. With this knowledge I can live with humane conduct. **This is the pending task we have to complete.**

65. Comment on the statement: “Nature is limited and space is unlimited.” Differentiate between units and space. CIE 3 QB 5 M

Ans. Nature has four orders and there are units in each order. **Each unit is limited in size.** The size ranges from being really small (an atom) to really big (galaxies). Each and every unit is **finite and limited** in size, be it the smallest particle or the biggest galaxy.

Space, on the other hand, is unlimited. Space has no ‘size’; unlike units, it is not bounded. There is no beginning or end to space, as there is to units.

Illustration. When we take a book, we know that it starts and finishes — the book is ‘limited’ in size. When we take space, there is no such thing. There is space behind us, inside us, between us and the book, between the book and the earth, in the book, in every page of it, inside the page, and beyond the earth — all the way till we can imagine. We find that space **pervades**; it is **all-pervading**. Units, on the other hand, are not all-pervading. This is precisely how we recognise them as units.

Units (Nature)	Space
Limited in size; bounded on six sides; countable and recognisable	Unlimited; not bounded; no beginning or end
Not all-pervading	All-pervading — present everywhere
Energised and active	Energy in equilibrium / constant energy
Four orders: material, pranic, animal, human	The medium in which all units exist, interact and are self-organised

66. Explain ‘energised’ and ‘energy in equilibrium’. CIE 3 QB 4 M

Ans. What we normally call or consider as energy today is the **transfer of energy**. For example, when we place water in a vessel on the stove, we say the heat energy from the flame was transferred to the water in the vessel.

Anything that is a **unit** has activity; and anything that has activity is **energised**. All the particles in the water and the metal stove are active, very active, and energised.

Hence we do not say that space is energised; we say “**space is energy in equilibrium**”, or that it is **constant energy**. All units are energised *in* space.

This energy is available to all units. In other words: **space is equilibrium energy; all units are in space; all units are energised and active being in space.**

Objective / Fill-in-the-Blank Question Bank with Answers

A. Multiple Choice (from the Quiz papers, with official answers)

#	Question	Answer
1	What is the fundamental principle of harmony in nature and existence? (a) Competition (b) Coexistence (c) Dominance (d) Isolation	(b) Coexistence
2	What is the role of human beings in maintaining harmony in nature? (a) Exploiting natural resources (b) Preserving and nurturing nature (c) Dominating other species (d) Isolating from the environment	(b) Preserving and nurturing nature
3	Which of the following best describes the Physical Order? (a) Includes only human-made objects (b) Comprises natural elements like soil, water, air and minerals (c) Refers exclusively to living beings (d) Focuses on mental and spiritual aspects	(b) Comprises natural elements like soil, water, air and minerals
4	What distinguishes the Human Order from the other three orders? (a) Physical strength (b) Intelligence and moral values (c) Ability to photosynthesise (d) Instinctual behaviour only	(b) Intelligence and moral values
5	In the context of coexistence, what is the meaning of 'prosperity'? (a) Material wealth accumulation (b) Holistic well-being and happiness (c) Physical strength and power (d) Technological superiority	(b) Holistic well-being and happiness
6	Comprehensive Human Goals include all the following except: (a) Resolution (b) Prosperity (c) Fearlessness (trust) (d) Isolation	(d) Isolation
7	Gratitude is considered a _____ value in relationships. (a) Cultural (b) Financial (c) Universal (d) Personal	(c) Universal
8	The word "society" is primarily used in the context of human _____ relationship. (a) Human (b) Nature (c) Both (d) None	(a) Human
9	Prosperity deals with: (a) Right understanding in the self (b) Fulfilment in relationship (c) Ensuring more than required physical facility (d) None	(c) Ensuring more than required physical facility
10	_____ is the feeling of responsibility towards the body of my relative. (a) Care (b) Guidance (c) Respect (d) Affection	(a) Care (mamata)
11	_____ means harmony within myself. (a) Pleasure (b) Happiness (c) Excitement (d) Fearlessness	(b) Happiness
12	The fourth order of nature is _____. (a) Bio order (b) Animal order (c) Human order (d) Material order	(c) Human order
13	The continuity of a plant species is maintained in nature by the _____ method. (a) Constitution conformance (b) Seed conformance (c) Right value / sanskaar (d) Breed conformance	(b) Seed conformance
14	There is _____ among the four orders of nature. (a) Inherent struggle (b) No dependency (c) Mutual fulfilment (d) Opposition	(c) Mutual fulfilment

15	Our natural acceptance is to live in _____ with nature. (a) Harmony (b) Struggle for survival (c) Opposition (d) None of the above	(a) Harmony
16	Production and work for physical facilities leads to _____ in family and _____ with nature. (a) Prosperity, existence (b) Happiness, existence (c) Happiness, co-existence (d) Prosperity, co-existence	(d) Prosperity, co-existence

B. Fill in the Blanks / One-liners

#	Question	Answer
1	_____ and Respect are considered the foundational values of a relationship.	Trust (vishvas)
2	Visualising a universal harmonious order in society includes the idea of an _____ Society and Universal Order, from family to world family.	Undivided (Akhanda Samaja)
3	Prosperity and fearlessness (trust) are part of the comprehensive human goals in _____ in society.	Right understanding (samadhana)
4	There are _____ comprehensive human goals.	Four — right understanding, prosperity, fearlessness (trust), co-existence
5	The human goal at the level of the individual is _____.	Right understanding (samadhana)
6	The human goal at the level of the family is _____.	Prosperity (samriddhi)
7	The human goal at the level of society is _____.	Fearlessness / trust (abhaya)
8	The human goal at the level of nature is _____.	Co-existence (saha-astitva)
9	Human-human interaction (its recognition, fulfilment and evaluation leading to mutual happiness) is called _____.	Justice (nyaya)
10	Human-rest-of-nature relation (recognition, fulfilment, evaluation leading to mutual prosperity) is called _____.	Preservation (suraksha) — enrichment, protection, right utilisation
11	Human values are essential for _____.	Harmony at all four levels of living — and hence for mutual fulfilment and mutual happiness in relationship
12	Mutual happiness in human-human interaction leads to _____.	Justice (nyaya) — mutual happiness ensured is the fourth element of justice
13	_____ is the foundation value (adhara mulya) in relationship.	Trust (vishvas)
14	What do you understand by complete value?	Love (prema) — the feeling of being related to all; hence called <i>purna mulya</i>
15	The value or participation of different orders in existence is also referred to as _____.	Natural characteristic (svabhava)
16	<i>Sah-astitva</i> means _____.	Co-existence
17	Which activity of the self indicates that “there is complementarity in nature and no opposition”?	Realization (and understanding) — activities 1 and 2 of the Self
18	Respect means _____.	Right evaluation — to be evaluated as I am

19	The three mistakes in evaluation are _____, _____ and _____.	Over evaluation (adhi-mulyana), under evaluation (ava-mulyana), otherwise evaluation (a-mulyana)
20	Ensuring justice in relationship, on the basis of values, leads to _____ in society.	Fearlessness / trust (abhaya)
21	The two mechanisms of self-exploration are _____ and _____.	Natural acceptance and experiential validation
22	Realization and understanding are tested for _____, _____ and _____.	Assurance, satisfaction and universality (same for all time, space and individual)
23	The needs of the Self are _____ and _____; the needs of the Body are _____ and _____.	Self: continuous and qualitative . Body: temporary and quantitative .
24	Sanyama is the basis of _____.	Svasthya (health)
25	The five dimensions of human endeavour are _____.	Siksha-Sanskara, Svasthya-Sanyama, Nyaya-Suraksha, Utpadana-Karya, Vinimaya-Kosha
26	The three aspects of <i>suraksha</i> are _____.	Enrichment (samvardhana), Protection (sanrakshana), Right utilisation (sadupayoga)
27	Production must be through a _____ process, in harmony with nature.	Cyclical (avartansheel) process — cyclic, and enriching every unit
28	Existence = _____ + _____.	Space + Units (in space) ; i.e. <i>nature submerged in space</i>
29	Space is _____ energy; units are _____.	Space is energy in equilibrium (constant energy); units are energised and active
30	Conformance in the four orders is _____, _____, _____ and _____.	Constitution, Seed, Breed, Sanskar conformance
31	The innateness of the human order at the level of 'I' is _____.	The will to live with happiness
32	The svabhava of the self ('I') in human beings is _____.	Perseverance (dhirata), bravery (virata) and generosity (udarata)
33	SVDD, SSDD and SSSS stand for _____.	Sadhan Viheen Dukhi Daridra; Sadhan Sampann Dukhi Daridra; Sadhan Sampann Sukhi Samriddha
34	Svatva, Swatantrata and Swarajya mean _____.	Innateness; self-organisation (harmony in oneself); self-expression (harmony with others)
35	The four elements of justice are _____.	Recognition of values, fulfilment, evaluation, mutual happiness ensured

Past-Paper Index — Where Each Question Has Appeared

CIE 1 — 22 June 2024 (HS248AT, 25 marks)

Q	Question	Marks	See Q#
1	Define self-exploration. What is the content of self-exploration?	5	Q8
2	“Right understanding + Relationship = Mutual fulfilment; Right understanding + Physical facilities = Mutual prosperity.” Illustrate with two examples for each.	8	Q20
3	How can we ensure harmony in self ('I')?	4	Q24
4	How do prosperity and wealth differ? What is more acceptable to us and why?	8	Q16

CIE 2 — 24 July 2024 (HS248AT, 5 + 25 marks)

Q	Question	Marks	See Q#
A1–5	Quiz: foundational values; undivided society; comprehensive human goals; gratitude	5	Part A
B1	What is the difference between respect and disrespect? Which of the two is naturally acceptable to you?	5	Q37
B2	How does affection lead to harmony in the family?	5	Q38
B3	What is the meaning of justice in human relationships? How does it follow from family to world family?	5	Q29
B4	What do you understand by trust? Differentiate between intention and competence with examples.	5	Q32
B5	Explain the comprehensive human goal. How does fearlessness follow from right understanding and prosperity?	5	Q42

CIE 3 / Improvement CIE — 28 August 2024 (HS248AT, 25 marks)

Q	Question	Marks	See Q#
A1–5	Quiz on harmony in nature, the physical order, the human order, coexistence	5	Part A
B1	Existence is co-existence of mutually interacting units in all-pervasive space. Explain.	5	Q62
B2	What is the natural characteristic (swabhava) of the human order? Explain.	5	Q54
B3	What are the four orders of nature? Briefly explain them.	5	Q51
B4	How can we say that ‘nature is Self-Organized and in space Self-Organization is Available’?	5	Q61
B5	Explain the difference and similarities between Pranic order and animal order. What is the relation between the two orders?	5	Q57

SEE — Sept/Oct 2024 (HS248AT) and Oct 2023 (21HSU48), 50 marks

Q	Question	Marks	See Q#
1.1–1.10	Part A — objective	10	Part A
2a	“To be in a state of harmony is happiness.” Explain and illustrate with two examples.	6	Q14
2a (alt)	Explain the process of self-exploration with a diagram.	6	Q9
2b	What do you mean by values? How do they differ from skills? How are values and skills complementary?	6	Q6
2b (alt)	What is value education? Describe the need for value education with its guidelines.	6	Q1, Q2, Q3
3a	What is the role of the value system in family harmony?	5	Q48
3a (alt)	Explain the problems faced due to differentiation in relationship.	5	Q36
3b	“Discrimination leads to acrimony in relationships.” Explain. What problems are created when we discriminate?	5	Q36
3b (alt)	What is ‘justice’? What are its four elements? Is it a continuous or a temporary need?	5	Q28
3c	Define love. How can you say that love is the complete value?	4	Q40
4a	What do you understand by trust? Differentiate between intention and competence with examples.	5	Q32
4a (alt)	Distinguish between the needs of the Self and the needs of the Body.	5	Q23
4b	Realization and understanding are essential for happiness and harmony. Explain.	5	Q26
4b (alt)	Feeling of love lays down the basis of an undivided society. Explain.	5	Q40
4c	Describe the concept of an undivided society and the universal order, and explain how both can help create a world family.	5	Q46
4c (alt)	Bring out the differences between respect and differentiation.	4	Q37
5a	Existence is co-existence of mutually interacting units in all-pervasive space. Explain. / Describe briefly the nature of co-existence.	5	Q62, Q63
5b	Define harmony in nature and why is it important. Explain with examples.	5	Q50
5b (alt)	What are the four orders of nature? Briefly explain them.	5	Q51
5c	What do you mean by co-existence?	4	Q63
6a	What is the natural characteristic (swabhava) of the human order? Explain.	5	Q54
6b	What are the four orders of nature? Briefly explain them.	5	Q51
6c	How can we say that ‘nature is Self-Organized and in space Self-Organization is Available’?	4	Q61
5c / 6b (2023)	<i>Holistic technology; ethical human conduct in terms of values, policy and character; nature of universal human order</i>	4–5	<i>Chapters 11–13 — outside the Unit I–III material supplied. Universal</i>

Last-minute revision priorities.

Unit I: the five needs for value education; the five guidelines; the process of self-exploration diagram; the five characteristics of natural acceptance; prosperity vs wealth; right understanding + relationship / + physical facilities; the Self vs Body needs table; the four-step process for harmony in 'I'.

Unit II: justice and its four elements; intention vs competence; respect as right evaluation and the three mistakes; the differentiation table (body / physical facilities / beliefs); the nine values with definitions; the comprehensive human goal and its sequence; the five dimensions of human endeavour and what each leads to.

Unit III: the single four-orders table (activity, innateness, svabhava, basic activity, conformance); existence = space + units; self-organisation; recyclability and self-regulation; interconnectedness and the missing mutual fulfilment from the human order.

Compiled from the HS248AT / 21HSU48 CIE 1 (June 2024), CIE 2 (July 2024), Quiz-3 & CIE 3 (August 2024) and SEE (Oct 2023, Sept/Oct 2024) papers; the official RVCE Scheme & Solution documents for CIE 2 (2022–23) and Quiz-3/CIE 3 (2023–24); the departmental Unit II and Unit III question banks; and *A Foundation Course in Human Values and Professional Ethics*, Chapters 1–10.